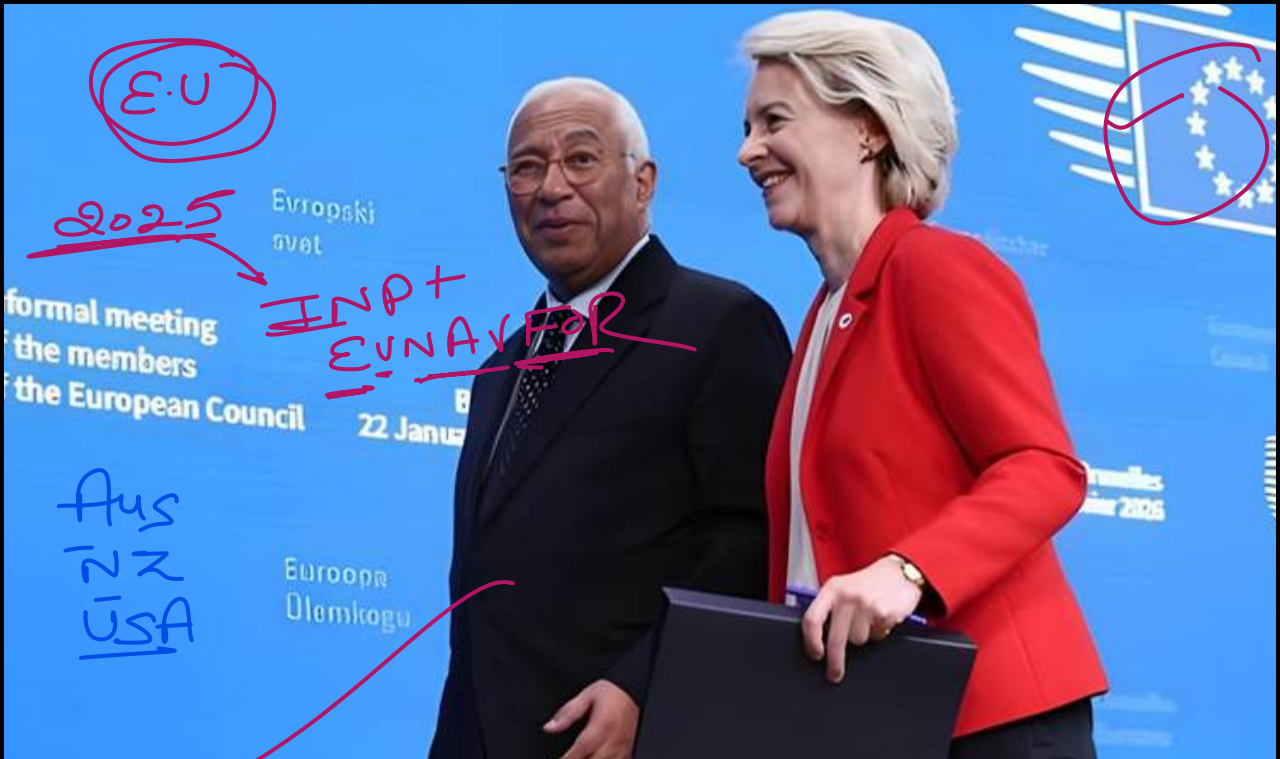


⇒ Good Evng.

NDA
2025

A hand-drawn diagram on a green background. It features a rectangular box with a dashed line inside, representing a path. The word "white" is written to the right of the box, and "Black" is written below the box, with an arrow pointing to the dashed line. There are also some scribbles to the left of the box.





#1 **India and the EU** established their first comprehensive **Security and Defence Partnership** during the EU leaders' visit for India's 77th Republic Day. The agreement includes maritime security, defense industry cooperation, defense technology, and space security.

cyber defence



⇒ E.U.

⇒ 27 countries

ww-2

Treaty of Paris
" " Rome



* 1992 → Maastricht Treaty

Belgium

Estab

E.U.

Brexit

H.Q. → Brussels
Luxemb.



India-EU Free Trade Agreement : **'Mother of All Deal'** ✓ FIA

- Agreement: India-EU Free Trade Agreement (FTA) concluded
- Partners: India (4th largest economy) & EU (2nd largest economy)

⇒ 1st Global trade pact 27

⇒ 22 Countries

→ FTA + EU

regulation
strict

27 countries
ratify

Europ. parliament

force ✓

Relate

⇒ textile
apparel
leather
footwear

Budget → Custom duty
tariff

① tax reduce

E.U. → 97%
or less

H.W
↓
super ki
value
girti import
export

97% categories

tariff
or less

99.5% India
export to E.U.

Market Access

- Zero-duty access for textiles & apparel across all tariff lines
- Tariff reduction up to 12%
- EU textile & apparel import market: USD 263.5 billion (₹22.9 lakh crore)

India-EU textile trade

- EU = 2nd largest destination for Indian textiles (after USA)
- India exports to EU: USD 7.2 billion (₹62.7 thousand crore)
- Major export composition:
 - Ready-made garments: ~60%
 - Cotton textiles: 17%



Key benefits

- Removes tariff disadvantage vis-à-vis Bangladesh, Pakistan, Turkey
- Boosts MSMEs, labour-intensive exports & women employment
- Sector employs ~45 million people directly

Beyond tariffs

- Reduction of non-tariff barriers
- Predictable, rules-based trade framework

Strategic significance

- Complements FTAs with UK & EFTA
- Supports export diversification
- Aligned with Viksit Bharat 2047 vision

Ministry of Commerce & Industry

75
Azadi Ka
Amrit Mahotsav

India-EU Free Trade Agreement Concluded: A Strategic Breakthrough in India's Global Trade Engagement

Historic Milestone Announced at the 16th India-EU Summit by Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi and European Commission President H.E. Ms. Ursula von der Leyen

India, 4th largest economy, and the European Union, 2nd largest economy, comprising 25% of Global GDP, Forge a Trusted Partnership,

Unprecedented Market Access: Over 99% of Indian exports gain preferential entry into the EU, unlocking massive growth potential

The FTA will open new opportunities for MSMEs and create jobs for women, artisans, youth and professionals

INR 6.41 Lakh Crore (USD 75 Billion) exports poised for take-off, 33 bn USD of exports in labour-intensive sectors like textiles, leather, marine products, gems and jewellery set to gain immensely from preferential access under the FTA

Carefully calibrated auto liberalisation with reciprocal market access to propel Make in India

Favourable Market Access Opens Doors for India's Agricultural and Processed Food Exports

India Safeguards sensitive Agricultural products and Dairy Sector: no market access.

Ambitious and Commercially Meaningful Market Access in Services

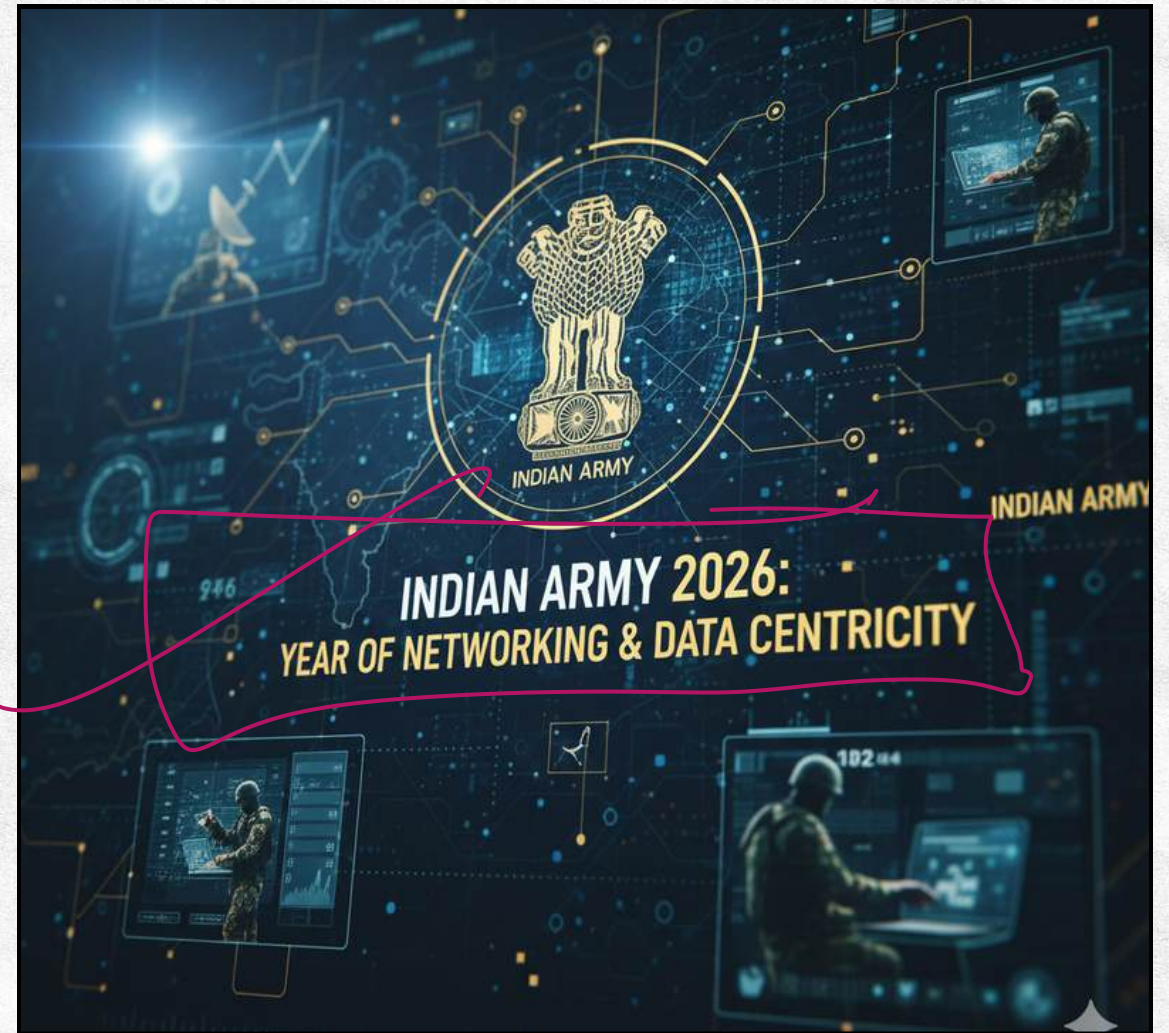
Future-Ready Mobility Framework Expands Global Opportunities for Skilled and Semi-Skilled Indian Professionals

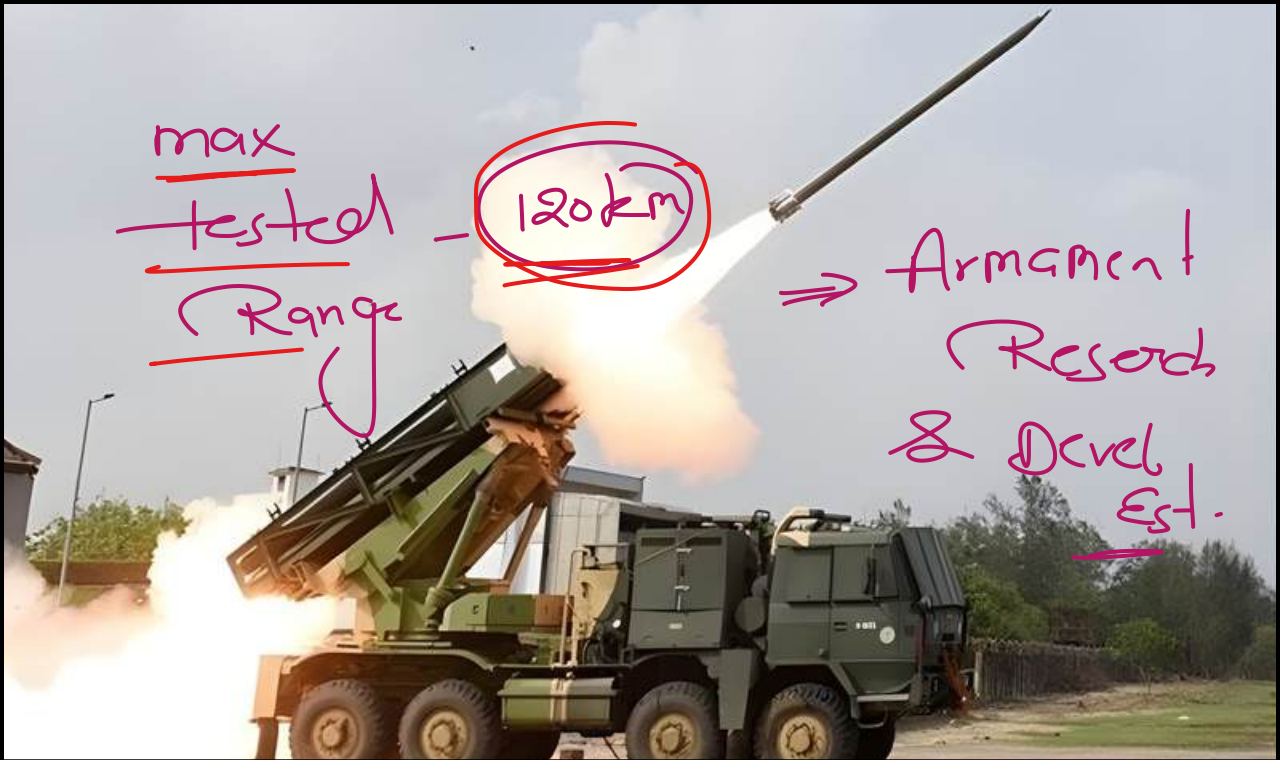
Forward looking CBAM provisions Secure constructive engagement, dialogue and support India-EU FTA Lays the Foundation for Inclusive, Resilient, and Future-Ready Growth

DEFENCE



The Indian Army has declared 2026 as the 'Year of Networking & Data Centricity' to improve situational awareness, expedite decision-making, and enhance combat effectiveness through integrated digital networks and real-time data flow.





The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) conducted the first flight test of the **Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR-120)** at the Integrated Test Range (ITR) in Chandipur, Odisha.

⇒ A tough → Research centre Imarad

→ High energy material ⇒ Terminal Ballistic Res. Lab Chandipur Hyd.

Res. Lab
Pinaka



The Defence Research and Development Organisation created the hand-operated **Sea Water Desalination System (SWaDeS)** to provide drinking water for soldiers in remote, coastal, and high-altitude regions.



The **Indian Coast Guard and Japan Coast Guard** conducted a joint HNS response drill in Mumbai. Held onboard **ICGS Samudra Prahari**, the exercise aimed to strengthen maritime safety, environmental protection, and disaster response cooperation.



Swedish defense firm **Saab** demonstrated the **RBS-15** missile's ability to target parts of the Russian S-400 air defense system. This **fire-and-forget missile** serves both anti-ship and land-attack roles and is developed by **Saab Bofors Dynamics**.

A-S **S-S** → **fire & forget missile**
Anti-ship
With land attack



Exercise DOSTI-17 concluded on 19 January 2026, with the **Maldives** hosting the 17th edition. It is a trilateral Coast Guard exercise involving **India, Sri Lanka and the Maldives**, with **ICGS Vajra** participating in harbour-phase activities including MARPOL and VBSS drills.

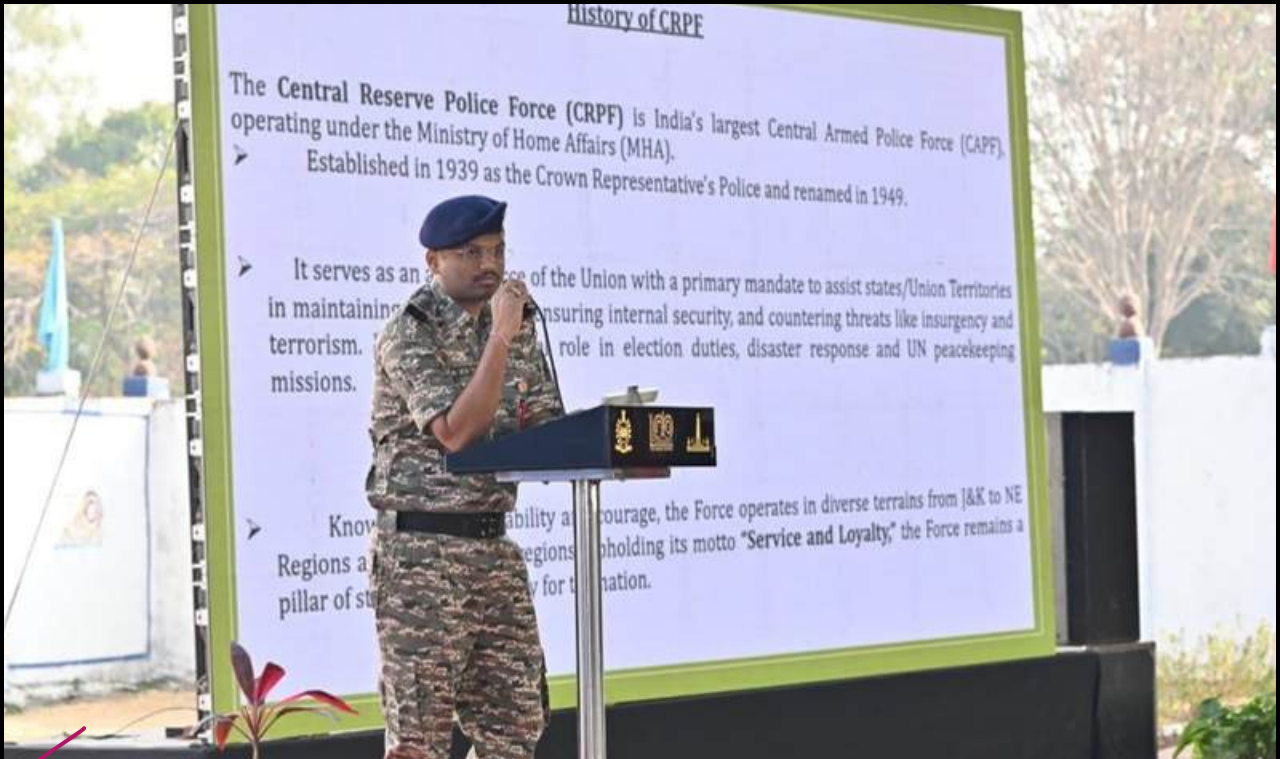
op.
Cody

86



Operation Parhar is a large-scale anti-gangster crackdown launched by the Punjab Police, involving about 2,000 teams and 12,000 personnel. The statewide drive targets 60 major gangsters and nearly 1,200 associates, under the supervision of **Punjab DGP Gaurav Yadav**.

FTA



Exercise Sanjha Shakti is a **Joint Military-Civil Fusion** exercise by the Indian Army at **Dighi Hills Range**, aimed at improving coordination between armed forces and civilian agencies in disaster response and public safety. Over 350 civil personnel participate alongside Army troops.



DRDO successfully tested the **Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM)**, a third-generation, **fire-and-forget missile** with top-attack capability. Developed for induction into the Indian Army, it can be launched from a tripod or military vehicle.

At the 77th Republic Day Parade, DRDO introduced the **Long Range Anti-Ship Hypersonic Missile (LR-AShM)** for the first time.

- **Developer:** DRDO (indigenous)
- **Purpose:** Coastal battery and sea-denial for the Indian Navy
- **Type:** **Hypersonic Glide Missile (HGV)**
- **Range:** ~1,500 km (future variants may reach 3,500 km)
- **Speed:** **Initial Mach 10, average Mach 5**
- **Trajectory:** Quasi-ballistic with manoeuvrability



Ladakh's double-humped Bactrian camels, known as "silent warriors," will debut at the 77th Republic Day parade.

- **Distribution:**

- Native to Central Asia, from Afghanistan to China
- Major habitats: Mongolian steppes and Gobi Desert
- In India: Nubra Valley (Ladakh), a high-altitude cold desert

Conservation status:

- IUCN Red List: **Critically Endangered**



fat → converted into water

Energy

Can eat snow

IIT Madras develops ramjet-assisted Artillery Shells

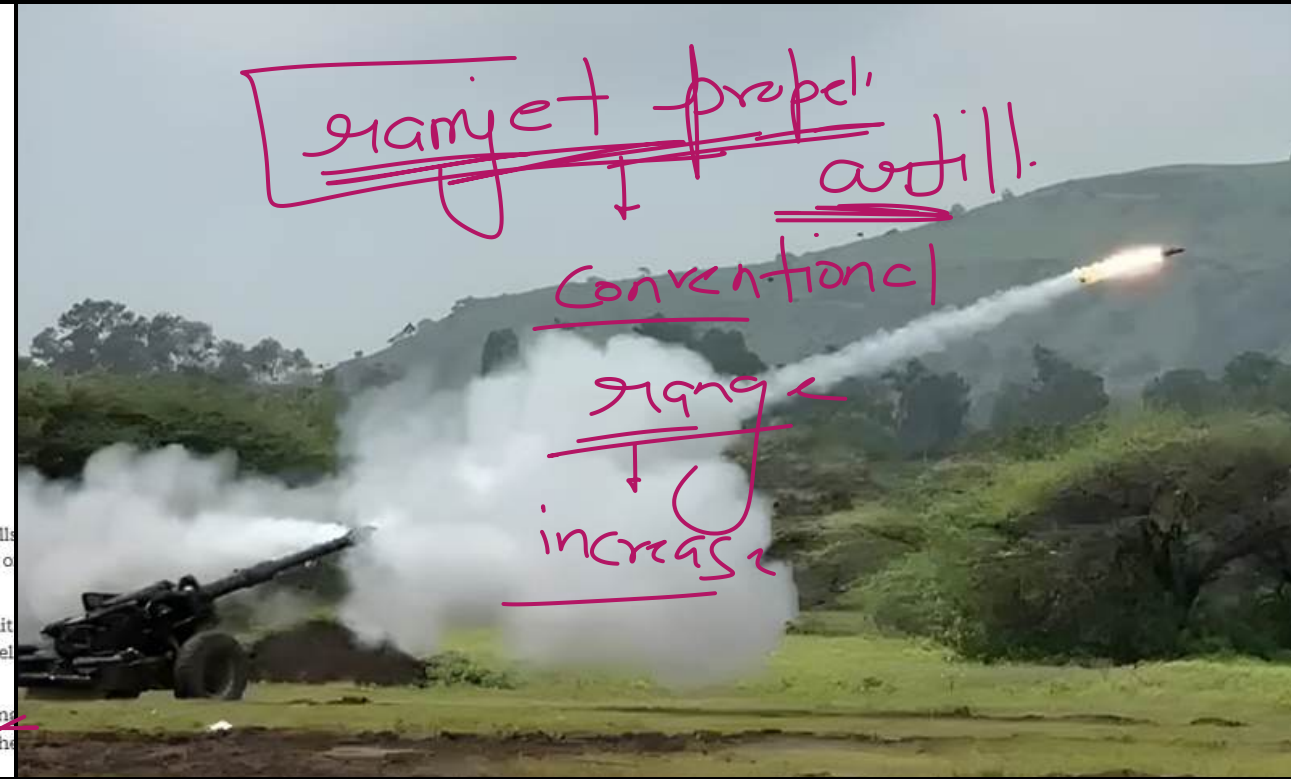
प्रविष्टि तिथि: 12 JAN 2026 3:46PM by PIB Chennai



Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras) researchers have successfully developed and tested ramjet-propelled artillery shells designed to dramatically extend the range of conventional gun systems. This marks a significant milestone in the indigenous development of defence technology.

The IIT Madras innovation integrates a ramjet engine into an existing 155 mm artillery shell, replacing the conventional base-bleed unit. Unlike rocket-assisted projectiles or incremental aerodynamic improvements, this approach enables sustained propulsion after the shell exits the barrel, significantly extending its reach while preserving the shell's destructive effectiveness on target.

A ramjet is a type of engine that uses the vehicle's high speed to compress incoming air, mix it with fuel, and generate thrust without moving parts like turbines. In artillery systems, ramjets allow shells to travel much farther after being fired, extending range without changing the gun itself. This gives armed forces greater reach and flexibility while keeping costs and complexity low.



IIT Madras has successfully developed and tested **ramjet-propelled 155 mm artillery shells**, which can enhance range by approximately 50%. Trials conducted in Deolali and Pokhran confirmed both stable flight and effective ramjet ignition.

Ramjet Artillery Shell

- A ramjet artillery shell has its own propulsion system.
- It is fired from a standard artillery gun.
- The ramjet engine activates after firing.

Feature	Normal Shell	Ramjet Shell
Propulsion after firing	No propulsion	Continuous air-breathing thrust
Range	Limited range	Much longer range
Flight mechanism	Follows ballistic trajectory	Sustained powered flight
Speed maintenance	Speed decreases rapidly	Maintains high speed over distance



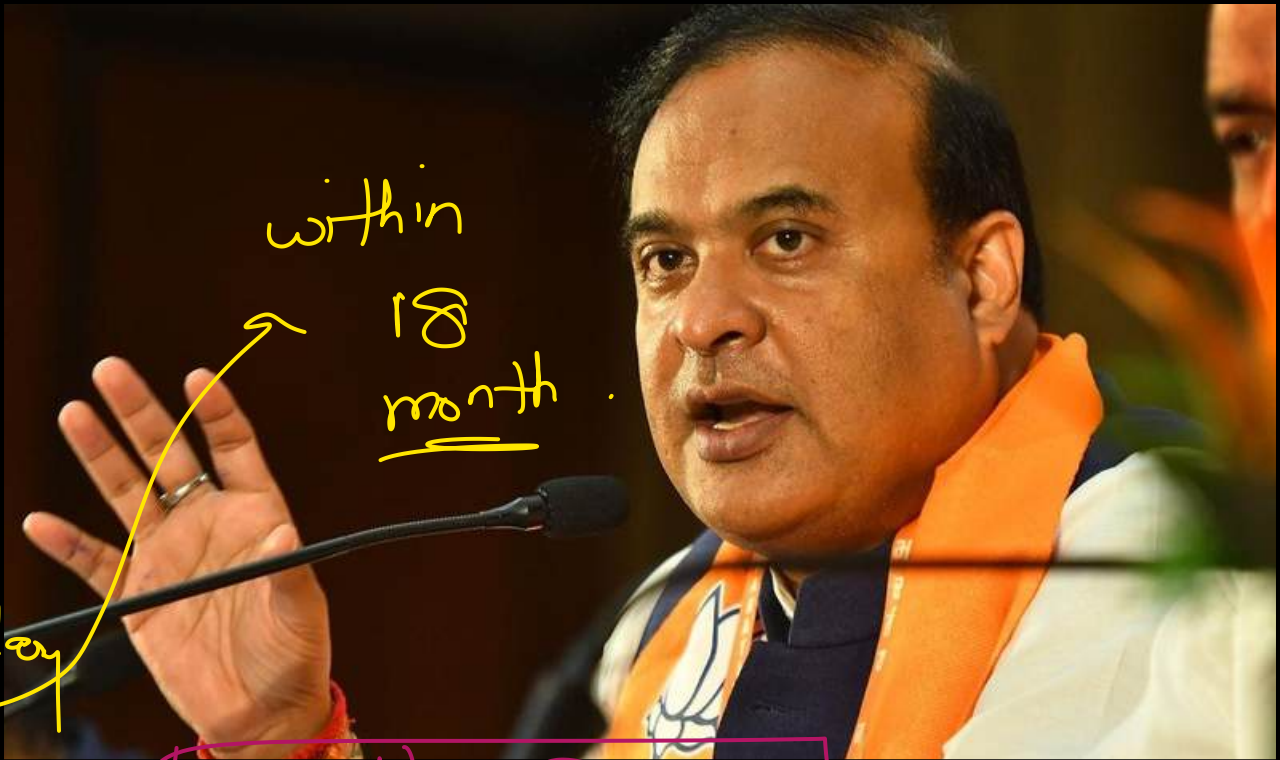
The Jharkhand Police launched **Operation Megaburu** in the **Saranda** forests to fight Maoism, with support from CRPF and CoBRA units. The operation targets **Maoist leader Patiram Manjhi, alias Anal Da.**

ICGS Adanya

Goo
Shp.

NATIONAL NEWS





Subhas Das

Assam has become the first state in India to constitute its 8th State Pay Commission, taking a proactive step ahead of the scheduled expiry of the 7th Pay Commission on January 1, 2026.



The **Rajasthan** government has launched a new digital communication initiative, "**e-Swasthya Samvad**," to promote transparency, coordination, and administrative efficiency in the medical education system

A.T. / S.B.

Shakti
80-55



India has surpassed Japan to become the world's **fourth-largest economy**, with a **GDP of USD 4.18 trillion**. It is projected to overtake **Germany by 2030**, reaching a GDP of USD 7.3 trillion.

- ① US (30.6 trillion)
- ② China
- ③ Germany



India has become the world's largest producer of rice, surpassing China in total output. India's rice production has been reported at 150.18 million tonnes, compared to China's 145.28 million tonnes.

Aus Aman

Boro



Karnataka has reported its first sighting of the ultra-rare strawberry-colored leopard, known as the Sandalwood Leopard. This marks only the second sighting of this species in India, with the first occurring in **Rajasthan in 2021**.

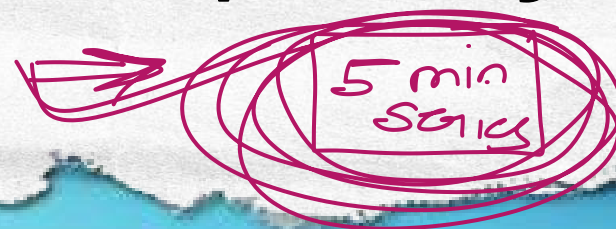


The **Bhoramdev Corridor Project** aims to develop the Bhoramdev Temple area, a key heritage and pilgrimage site known as the "**Khajuraho of Chhattisgarh**." Inaugurated in Kabirdham district, it is part of the **Swadesh Darshan Scheme 2.0**.

2014-15
Central govt → theme based → tourist circuit
poora paisa



Under "**Operation Milap,**" Delhi police located 1,303 missing persons using modern technology and systematic follow-ups on long-standing cases.





Haryana will launch **India's first hydrogen-powered train**, now in the final commissioning phase with a hydrogen plant ready in **Jind**. This pilot project by Northern Railway will operate on the **Jind to Sonipat route**.



Sanskaar Shaala, a value-based program for children aged 4-14, was launched by the **Assam Government** in Guwahati to foster ethical, social, and cultural awareness.



India has made history as the **first country to commercially produce bio-bitumen for road construction**. This bio-based binder is derived from renewable sources such as vegetable oils, crop stubble, algae, lignin, and animal manure.



The **Adani Group** has started the **570-megawatt (MW) Wangchhu Hydro Electricity Project in Bhutan**. It is a run-of-river hydropower project on the Wangchu River in Chukha district, Bhutan. The **Wangchu River, called Raidāk River in India**, is a tributary of the Brahmaputra River.

PM Marks 1000 Years Since First Attack on Somnath Temple

1026 A.D

2026

- **Location:** Prabhas Patan, Gujarat coast.
- **Religious status:** **First Jyotirling** among 12 Shiva Jyotirlingas (Shiva Purana, Dwadasha Jyotirling Stotram).
- **Tirth significance:** Ancient Tirthdham revered with Ganga-Yamuna-Saraswati.
- **Rebuilt in stone by King Bhimdev I (Solanki dynasty) after 1026 CE attack.**
- **Attacked multiple times: 1026, 1297, 1394, 1706 CE (Aurangzeb).**

Social Welfare

Somnath Swabhiman Parv

A Thousand Years of Deep-rooted Faith and Civilisational Pride

Posted On: 10 JAN 2026 9:48AM

Key Takeaways:

- Somnath Swabhiman Parv (8-11 January, 2026) commemorates 1,000 years since the first attack by Mahmud of Ghazni on the Somnath Temple in 1026.
- The Parv celebrates the enduring spirit of India's civilisation and rich cultural and spiritual heritage.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi to visit Somnath on 10-11 January, 2026 to participate in key commemorative events.
- Somnath temple draws 92-97 lakh devotees annually.
- Women play a central role at Somnath. The Somnath Temple Trust employs 262 women among 906 employees; in total around 363 women get employment generating about ₹9 crore annually through the temple.

Introduction

सौराष्ट्रे सोमनाथं च श्रीशैले मल्लिकार्जुनम् ।
उज्जयिन्यां महाकालम् उकारममलेश्वरम् ।

Women Role

This opening verse of the *Dwadasha Jyotirlinga Stotram* places Somnath in Gujarat, at the very beginning of the twelve sacred Jyotirlingas, signifying its place in India's spiritual heritage. It reflects the civilisational belief that Somnath is the foundation of Bharat's spiritual geography. Located at Prabhas Patan near Veraval in Gujarat, Somnath is not merely a place of worship but a living symbol of India's civilisational continuity.

For centuries, Somnath drew the reverence and prayers of millions. It was repeatedly targeted by invaders whose intent was destruction, not devotion. Yet, Somnath's story is defined by the indomitable courage, faith and resolve of crores of dedicated followers.

Swabhiman Parv: A National Expression of Collective Pride

The *Somnath Swabhiman Parv* is being organised from 8 January to 11 January 2026 as a national commemoration marking one thousand years since the first recorded attack on the Somnath Temple in January 1026.

The observance has been conceived not as a remembrance of destruction, but as a tribute to resilience, faith and civilisational self-respect. Over centuries, Somnath was repeatedly targeted by invaders whose objective was demolition rather than devotion. Each time, however, the temple was rebuilt through the collective resolve of devotees like Devi Ahilya Bai Holkar. This unbroken cycle of revival has made Somnath a powerful symbol of India's civilisational continuity.



The **Bhadrakali inscription** (1169 CE) is a significant 12th-century document that verifies royal support and the historical growth of the Somnath Temple in Prabhas Patan, Gujarat. It corresponds to **Valabhi Samvat 850 and Vikram Samvat 1255** and is safeguarded by the State Archaeology Department.





UIDAI has launched a resident-facing Aadhaar mascot named **Uдай**. The mascot aims to simplify Aadhaar-related communication and improve citizen awareness.

Ministry of Women and Child Development launches PANKHUDI – an Integrated Digital Portal to Strengthen Partnerships for Women and Child Development

Launch of PANKHUDI portal marks a significant step towards leveraging digital solutions for inclusive, collaborative, and outcome-oriented development of women and children across India

Enhances ease of doing CSR and partnerships with the Government through a transparent, trusted, and technology-enabled framework

प्रसिद्धि तिथि: 08 JAN 2026 3:00PM by PIB Delhi

The Government of India accords the highest priority to the welfare, protection, and empowerment of women and children across the country. In furtherance of this commitment, the Ministry of Women and Child Development launched PANKHUDI, an integrated Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) and partnership facilitation digital portal aimed at strengthening coordination, transparency, and structured stakeholder participation in initiatives for women and child development.

The PANKHUDI Portal was launched today (8 January 2026) by the Union Minister for Women and Child Development, Smt. Annapurna Devi, in the august presence of the Minister of State for Women and Child Development, Smt. Savitri Thakur, and Secretary, Ministry of Women and Child Development, Shri Anil Malik.



The **PANKHUDI portal**, launched on January 8, 2026, by Union Minister Smt. Annapurna Devi, is a **digital platform for women and child development initiatives**. It connects government, citizens, NGOs, NRIs, and corporates.

BHASHINI Samudaye: Strengthening India's Language AI Ecosystem

Posted On: 12 JAN 2026 6:19PM by PIB Delhi

The Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD), Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) will organise BHASHINI Samudaye: Strengthening India's Language AI Ecosystem on 13 January 2026 at Nalanda Hall, Dr Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi.

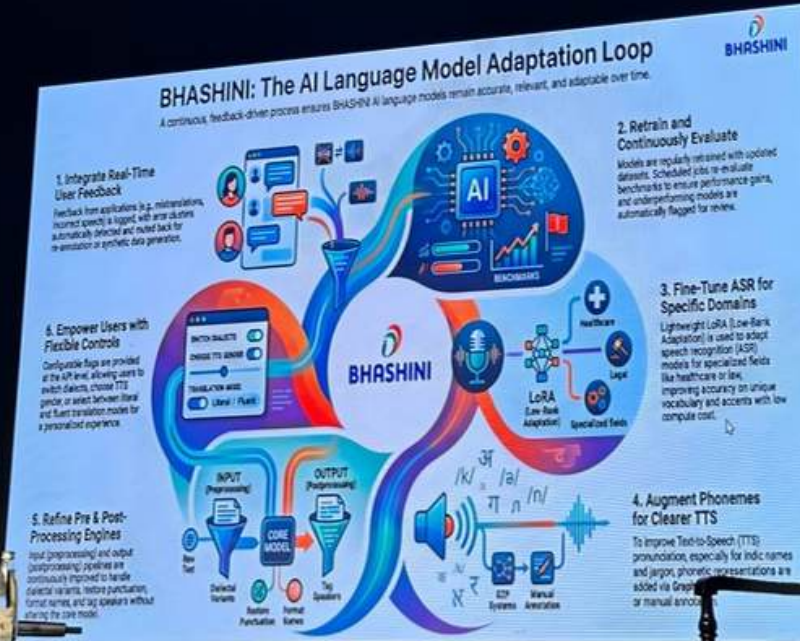
BHASHINI Samudaye is a BHASHINI-led collaborative initiative that brings together language experts, academic institutions, civil society organisations, and data practitioners to co-create, govern, and scale language AI solutions for India. The initiative reinforces BHASHINI's mandate under the National Language Translation Mission (NLTM) to eliminate language barriers and ensure access to digital services in all Indian languages.

The workshop will begin with welcome remarks and felicitation of guests, followed by the formal inauguration. Senior leadership from MeitY and the Digital India BHASHINI Division will outline BHASHINI's vision for building a coordinated, sovereign, and inclusive language AI ecosystem, anchored in public digital infrastructure, community participation, and ethical data practices.

A fireside chat featuring Shri Amitabh Nag, Chief Executive Officer, Digital India BHASHINI Division, will reflect on the evolution of BHASHINI as a national language AI platform and the role of ecosystem partnerships in scaling multilingual AI for governance, education, and public service delivery. The session will be moderated by Shri Arjun Venkatraman, Senior Officer – Artificial Intelligence, Gates Foundation.

The workshop will feature focused sessions on scaling BHASHINI, including discussions on platform capabilities, strategic priorities, and pathways for collaboration with institutions, states, and implementation partners. Shri Shailendra Pal Singh, Senior General Manager, Digital India BHASHINI Division, will present BHASHINI's roadmap for platform expansion and ecosystem engagement.

A dedicated session on the BHASHINI Samudaye Platform will enable structured presentations and feedback from partners, strengthening participatory governance models and collaborative contribution mechanisms. The workshop will also showcase BHASHINI in Action, including live demonstrations, real-world use cases, and a walkthrough of BhashaDaan, BHASHINI's citizen contribution platform, led by Shri Ajay Singh Rajawat, Senior Manager, Digital India BHASHINI Division.



The **BHASHINI Samudaye** workshop in New Delhi aimed to enhance **India's Language AI ecosystem**. Organized by **MeitY**, it focused on developing BHASHINI as a national platform for multilingual governance and public services to eliminate language barriers in digital access across India.



"Boda Tyohar", the biggest annual festival of the Hatti tribe, recently began with traditional fervour in Sirmour district of Himachal Pradesh. The Hatti tribe is located along the Himachal Pradesh Uttarakhand border in the **Giri and Tons river** basin, tributaries of the Yamuna River.



The **Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS)** released 15 critically endangered Indian vultures in the Melghat Tiger Reserve, Maharashtra. Melghat lies in the Satpura range (Gavilgarh Hills) and is Maharashtra's first tiger reserve, strengthening vulture conservation efforts



The Centre has granted a **GI tag** to **Nagauri Ashwagandha**, also known as **Indian ginseng or winter cherry**. It is mainly grown in Nagaur district of Rajasthan, where dry climate and sandy soil suit its cultivation.



Pongal is a major harvest festival of **Tamil Nadu** celebrated during the **Tamil month of Thai**. It marks the start of Uttarayan after the winter solstice. The festival is dedicated to the **Sun God** and observed as a four-day thanksgiving to nature and farmers.



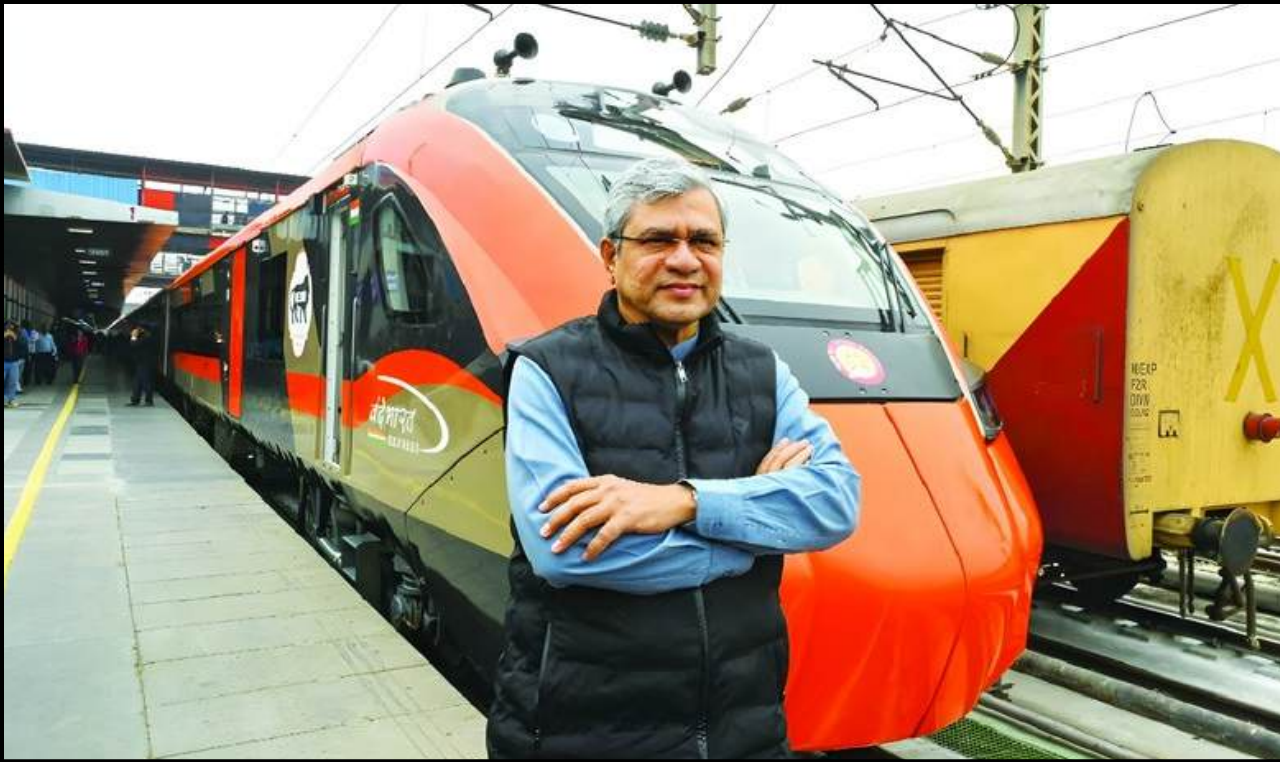
Bharat Electricity Summit 2026 will be held from 19–22 March 2026 at Yashobhoomi, New Delhi. It aims to showcase India's leadership in clean energy transition and resilient electricity systems. The theme is **"Electrifying Growth. Empowering Sustainability. Connecting Globally."**



GAIL (India) Ltd has completed the 694 km Mumbai-Nagpur Natural Gas Pipeline (MNPL). The pipeline is laid along the Samruddhi Mahamarg utility corridor, marking a first-of-its-kind integration under the PM GatiShakti framework.



The **Tamil Nadu government** signed an agreement with **Sarvam AI**, an Indian generative AI company, to establish **India's first full-stack Sovereign AI Park**. The project involves an initial investment of ₹10,000 crore and is expected to generate 1,000+ high-skilled jobs.



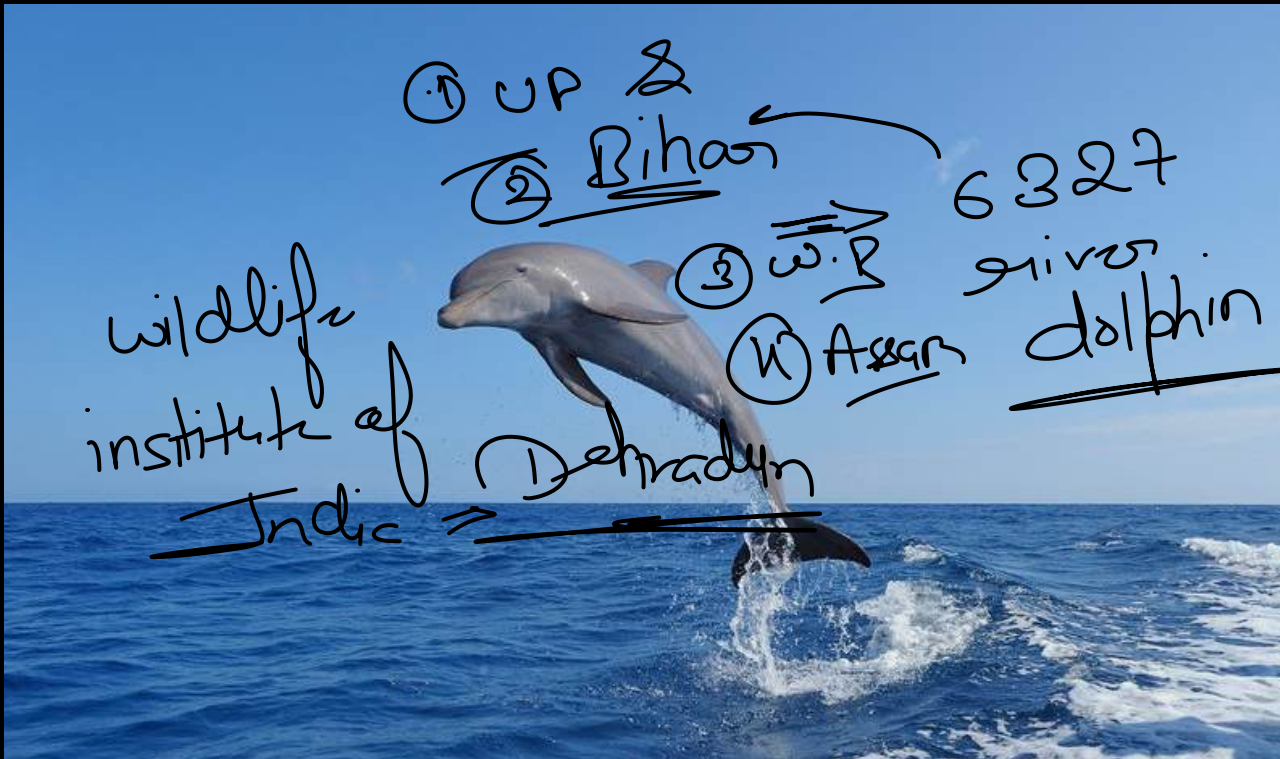
India's **first sleeper Vande Bharat train** was flagged off on 17 January 2026. It connects **Howrah (West Bengal)** with **Guwahati/Kamakhya (Assam)** and features sleeping berths like Rajdhani-class trains. The fully Made-in-India train reflects Indian Railways' push for modernization and self-reliance.



The 77th Republic Day celebrations focus on the theme **"150 Years of Vande Mataram¹."** For the first time, the Indian Army will showcase a phased battle array display during the parade, emphasizing integrated combat readiness.



Kokborok Day is observed annually on **19 January** in **Tripura** to mark the recognition of Kokborok as an official state language. Belonging to the **Tibeto-Burman language** family, 2026 marks the **48th anniversary** of its official language status.



India launched the **second range-wide Dolphin Survey** under Project Dolphin to estimate dolphin populations, assess habitats, and identify threats. This wildlife conservation initiative, started in **2020** by the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change**, aims to protect riverine and oceanic dolphins.

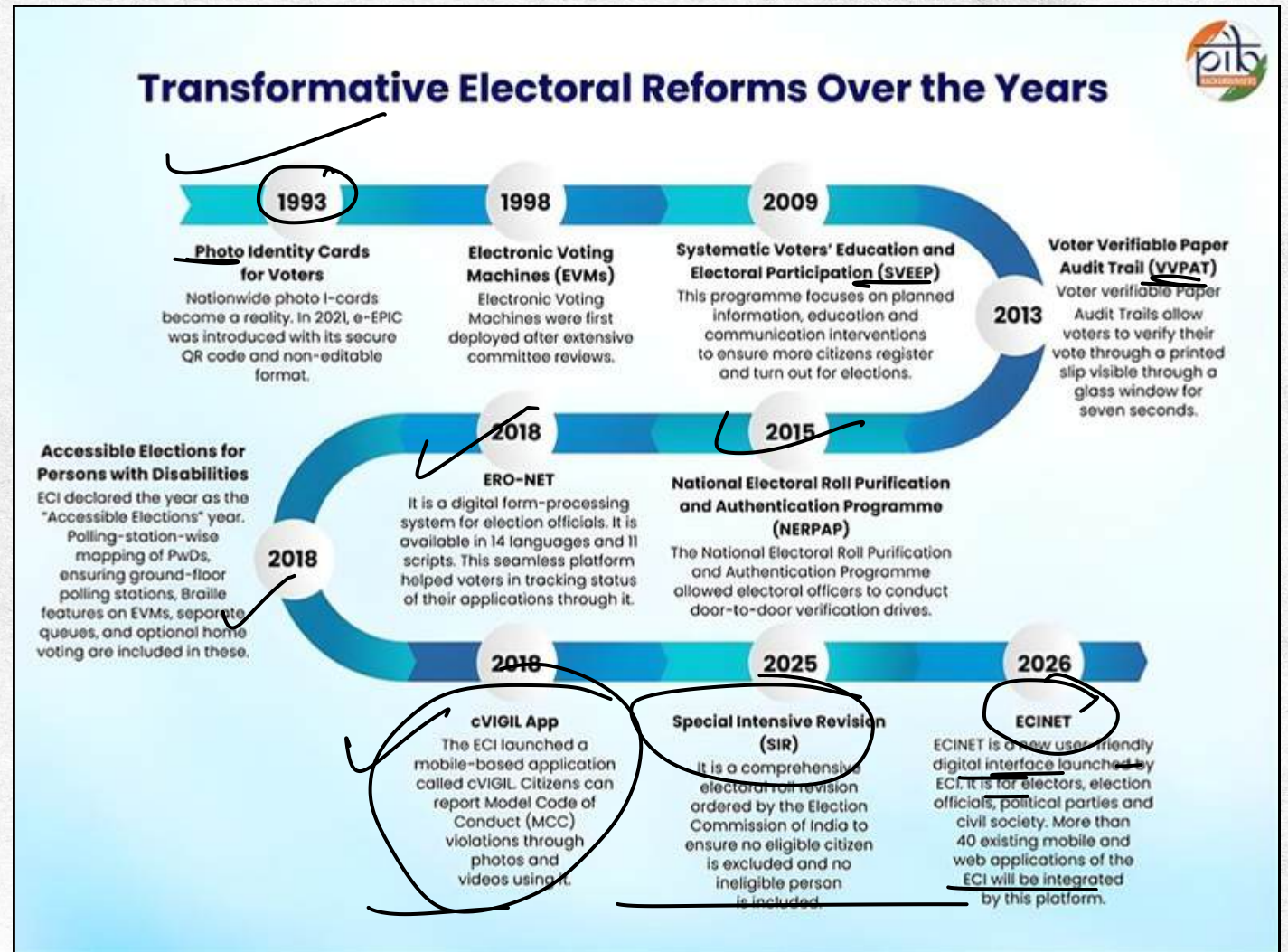


Bharat Rang Mahotsav (BRM) 2026, the 25th edition of the **world's largest international theatre festival**, will be organised by the **National School of Drama (NSD)** from 27 January to 20 February 2026. For the first time, artists from all seven continents will participate

v. imp.

National Voters' Day 2026
was celebrated on **January 25**, honoring the Election Commission of India (established in 1950).

- The theme was **"My India, My Vote"** with the tagline **"Citizen at the Heart of Indian Democracy."**





The top leadership of the European Union – Ursula von der Leyen, President of the European Commission, and António Costa, President of the European Council – attended India's 77th Republic Day celebrations on 26 January 2026 as Chief Guests.



Maharashtra is the first Indian state to set up dedicated menopause clinics in government hospitals and urban health facilities. The initiative aims to provide women-centric healthcare for physical and mental health issues during menopause.



The **53rd New Delhi World Book Fair** will be held from **January 10** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**. The fair is organised by the **National Book Trust (NBT)**.

- **Qatar is the Guest of Honour country, while Spain is the Focus Country.**
- **Theme :- Indian Military History: Valour and Wisdom @75**

v. imp

India holds the **third-largest rare earth reserves** but produces less than 1% globally.

Not same? to exst

15 lanthanoids +

Abundance

17 metal + Scandium

same to search

RARE EARTH MINERALS

- Group of 17 critical minerals
- Vital for EVs, wind turbines, electronics, defense systems, magnets, and batteries.
- **India:** 6.9 million tonnes
- **China:** 44 million tonnes
- **Brazil:** 21 million tonnes



China - 48%

India - 6%

The Prime Minister led the **50th PRAGATI meeting**, emphasizing its importance in accelerating major projects and welfare schemes.

ABOUT PRAGATI:

- **Launched: 2015**
- **Nature: Technology-enabled governance platform**
- **Project Monitoring: Real-time tracking via digital platforms**
- **Grievance Redressal: Integrated with CPGRAMS**

Prime Minister's Office

 PM chairs 50th meeting of PRAGATI

In last decade, PRAGATI led ecosystem has helped accelerate projects worth more than ₹85 lakh crore:
PM

PM's Mantra for the Next Phase of PRAGATI: Reform to Simplify, Perform to Deliver, Transform to Impact

PM says PRAGATI is essential to sustain reform momentum and ensure delivery

PM says Long-Pending Projects have been Completed in National Interest

PRAGATI exemplifies Cooperative Federalism and breaks Silo-Based Functioning: PM

PM encourages States to institutionalise PRAGATI-like mechanisms especially for the social sector at the level of Chief Secretary

In the 50th meeting, PM reviews five critical infrastructure projects spanning five states with a cumulative cost of more than ₹40,000 crore

Efforts must be made for making PM SHRI schools benchmark for other schools of state governments:
PM



The Union Health Ministry has banned all **oral Nimesulide** formulations above 100 mg due to safety concerns. This **nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug (NSAID)** is already banned for children under 12 and prohibited for veterinary use in India.

Jharkhand recently enforced the **Panchayat (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act (PESA)** after **25 years of statehood**, fully covering 13 districts and partially applying in three. Key points include:

- **Objective:** Extend Panchayati Raj to tribal areas.
- **Focus:** Strengthen tribal self-governance.
- **Key Institution:** Gram Sabha as the central authority.
- **Powers Granted:** Control over natural resources, local development, and social justice.



1954

Padma Awards 2026 announced

500k

Posted On: 25 JAN 2026 7:13PM by PIB Delhi

Padma Awards - one of the highest civilian Awards of the country, are conferred in three categories, namely, Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan and Padma Shri. The Awards are given in various disciplines / fields of activities, viz.- art, social work, public affairs, science and engineering, trade and industry, medicine, literature and education, sports, civil service, etc. 'Padma Vibhushan' is awarded for exceptional and distinguished service; 'Padma Bhushan' for distinguished service of high order and 'Padma Shri' for distinguished service in any field. The awards are announced on the occasion of Republic Day every year.

These Awards are conferred by the President of India at ceremonial functions which are held at Rashtrapati Bhawan usually around March / April every year. For the year 2026, the President has approved conferment of 131 Padma Awards including 2 duo cases (in a duo case, the Award is counted as one) as per list below. The list comprises 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri Awards. 19 of the awardees are women and the list also includes 6 persons from the category of Foreigners / NRI / PIO / OCI and 16 Posthumous awardees.

In 2026, the President approved 131 Padma Awards, including two duo cases. The awards include 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, and 113 Padma Shri recipients, recognizing contributions in three categories of India's highest civilian honors.



Padma Vibhushan (5) awardees are--

- **Shri Dharmendra Singh Deol** (Posthumous) – Art – Maharashtra
- **Shri K. T. Thomas** – Public Affairs – Kerala
- **Ms. N. Rajam** – Art – Uttar Pradesh
- **Shri P. Narayanan** – Literature and Education – Kerala
- **Shri V. S. Achuthanandan** (Posthumous) – Public Affairs – Kerala

INTERNATIONAL NEWS





Saudi Arabia carried out airstrikes on **Mukalla**, a port city of Yemen. The attack took place in the early hours of 30 December 2025. The airstrikes were launched after ships arrived there from **Fujairah**, a port city on the UAE's eastern coast.



China released rare footage of the **YJ-20 hypersonic anti-ship missile** fired from a **Type 055** guided missile destroyer warship. YJ-20, also called **Eagle Strike-20**, is a hypersonic anti-ship missile developed by China



China has recently strengthened its naval power by commissioning a new **advanced warship** named **Loudi**. The Loudi is a **Type 052D** guided missile destroyer inducted into the People's Liberation Army (PLA) Navy



India and Bhutan have signed an MoU to allow Bhutanese law clerks to work in the Supreme Court of India. The initiative focuses on judicial exchange, training, and long-term institutional cooperation.



Operation Hawkeye is a joint military operation conducted by the **United States and Jordan in Syria** to target ISIS infrastructure and fighters.



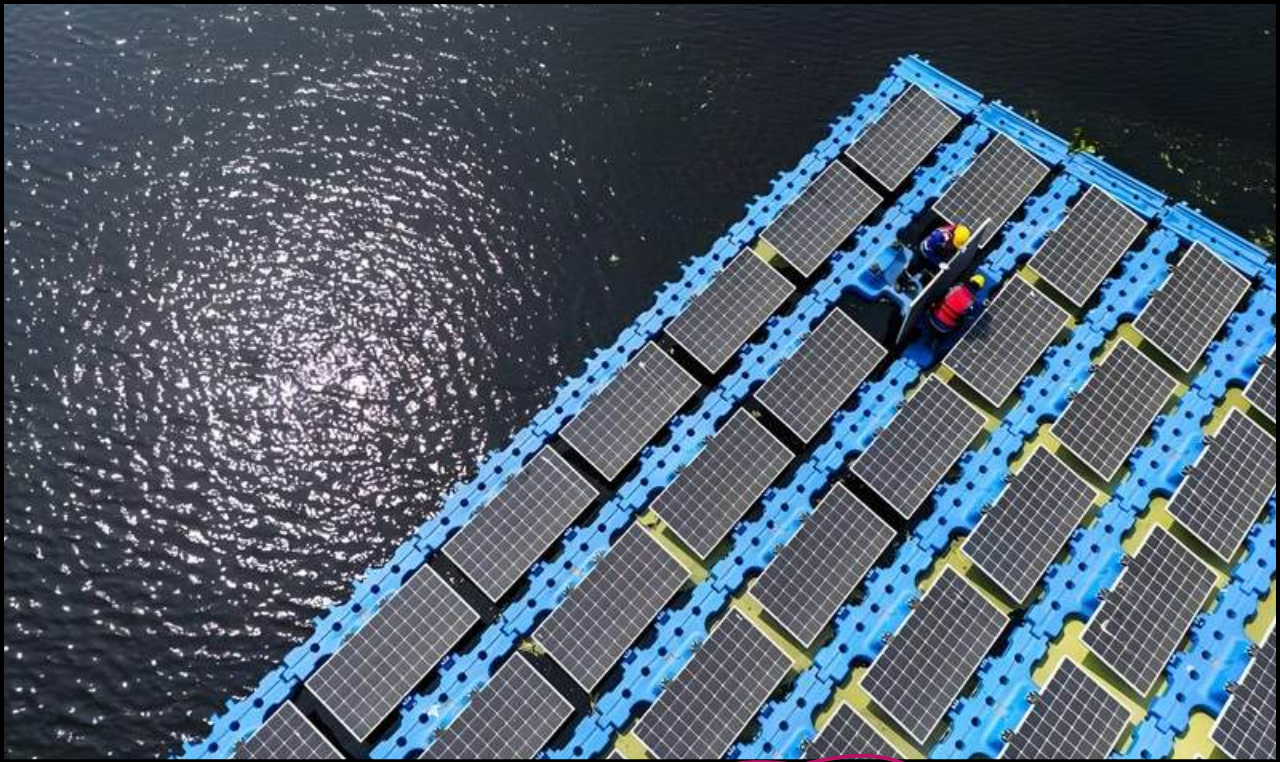
Abla El Hawary became the **first woman** to preside over **Egypt's Parliament** in its 160-year history during the opening session. At 79, she chaired the inaugural sitting for the 2026 legislative term as the senior-most member, as per constitutional procedure.



Kochi will host the **9th International Spice Conference (ISC 2026)** from 23-26 February 2026. The conference is organised by the **All-India Spices Exporters Forum (AISEF)**. The theme of ISC 2026 is **"Spice 360 – Getting Future Ready"**.

Venezuelan leader **Maria Corina Machado** symbolically handed her **Nobel Peace Prize medal to Donald Trump** in January 2026. The Nobel Committee clarified that the laureate title is non-transferable—only the medal or prize money can be gifted. Trump does not become a Nobel Peace Prize winner through this gesture.





On January 7, 2026, the **US** announced its withdrawal from **66** international organizations, including the **International Solar Alliance**. This decision affects 35 non-UN and 31 UN-affiliated entities, such as IRENA and IPCC, and follows an "**America First**" review, ending approximately USD 2.1 million in US contributions from 2022 to 2025.



The **2nd Global Buddhist Summit** will be held on 24–25 January 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. It is being organised by the International Buddhist Confederation (IBC) in collaboration with the Ministry of Culture. The first summit was held in 2023.



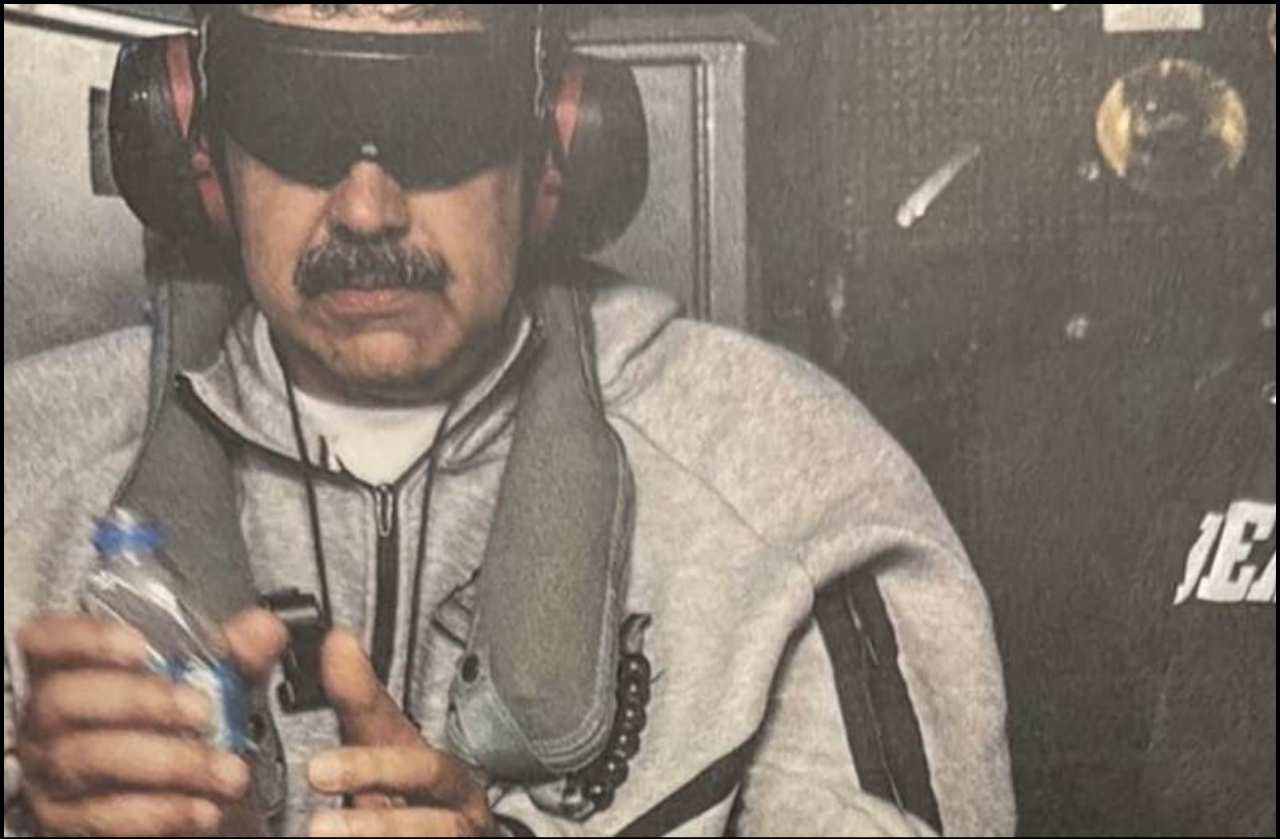
Israel will join the **Board of Peace**, proposed and chaired by **US President Donald Trump**. The body is intended to oversee the Gaza ceasefire and post-war reconstruction, with indications that it may also be used to address other global conflicts beyond Gaza.

under UNSC resolution 2823

India → received
invited

- India launched the **BRICS Presidency 2026 logo** and official website in New Delhi, set to assume the **chairship in 2026**.
- The logo, inspired by the **lotus**, symbolizes cultural identity, with inner petals forming joined hands in a "**Namaste**" gesture and **five** colored petals representing the founding BRICS members: **Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa**.





The **United States** has initiated **Operation Absolute Resolve**, resulting in the apprehension of **Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro** on charges of drug trafficking and narco-terrorism.



MERCOSUR is gaining attention amid Venezuela's political instability and US intervention debates in **Latin America**, focusing on economic alignment, regional stability and South American geopolitics

MERCOSUR Overview:



- Full form: **Southern Common Market.**
- Type: **Latin American regional trade bloc.**
- Established: **1991 under the Treaty of Asuncion.**
- Founding members: **Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay, Uruguay;** later members include **Venezuela and Bolivia.**
- Objective: Free movement of goods, services, capital, and people.
- Headquarters: **Montevideo, Uruguay.**
- Official languages: **Spanish and Portuguese.**
- Global standing: **4th largest integrated market after EU, NAFTA, and ASEAN.**

Trump's proposal to acquire Greenland has met strong opposition from Denmark and European allies over sovereignty and international law issues.



The USA wants Greenland for several reasons:

- To **counter Russia** in the Arctic
- To restrict China's access to **Arctic trade** routes and minerals
- To control **rare earth supply** and reduce dependence on China
- To view Greenland as a **strategic shield**.

- Greenland is the **world's largest island** and a self-governing territory of **Denmark**, known locally as **Kalaallit Nunaat**, located in the North Atlantic and Arctic regions
- The **Greenland Ice Sheet** covers about 80% of the island and is a significant climate-change indicator.
- Geologically, it consists of ancient Precambrian rocks from the Canadian Shield, with a terrain featuring **fjords**, glaciers, and fast-flowing outlets like **Jakobshavn Glacier**.
- Greenland is rich in **rare earth elements**, **critical minerals**, and **hydrocarbons**, becoming increasingly important in the global energy and technology transitions.





Recent reports indicated that the US ~~pressured~~ India to withdraw from **Iran's Chabahar Port**, but officials confirmed that India will continue its presence there due to its strategic importance and is working with the US to reach a compromise.

Chabahar Port Overview:

- **Location:** Deep-water port in Sistan-Baluchistan, Iran, near the Gulf of Oman.
- **Strategic Importance:** Iran's only deep-sea port with direct ocean access, enabling India to securely access large cargo vessels.
- **Terminals:** Includes Shahid Beheshti and Shahid Kalantari; India is developing the Shahid Beheshti Terminal.
- **Agreement:** Established by the Chabahar Agreement (2016) between India, Iran, and Afghanistan for regional connectivity.
- **Operations:** Managed by India Ports Global Ltd (IPGL) since December 2018.

SPOTLIGHT

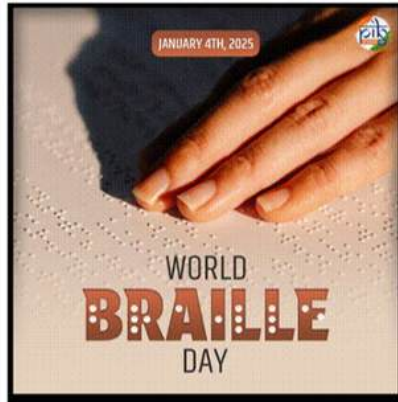


World Braille Day

Honoring Inclusion, Innovation, and Independence

प्रतिष्ठित तिथि: 03 JAN 2025, 10:00 AM, PIB Delhi

World Braille Day, observed on January 4th, commemorates the birthday of Louis Braille, the visionary who developed a tactile script that revolutionized communication for blind and partially sighted individuals. Celebrated globally since 2019, this day highlights the significance of Braille in empowering visually impaired individuals to access education, information, and opportunities, fostering their full participation in society.



On **World Braille Day (January 4)**, India highlighted its commitment to improving Braille literacy and accessibility for the visually impaired via organizations like the Rehabilitation Council of India and Braille Library Service. The **Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016**, and **NEP 2020** support inclusive education and participation.

Supercomputer simulation of ice formation gives evidence of paradoxical phenomenon of water

Posted On: 06 JAN 2026 5:54PM by PIB Delhi

Scientists have developed the first supercomputer-powered simulations to capture the long existing paradox of water that had eluded scientists for long-- hotter water freezing faster than colder water, a phenomenon technically called Mpemba effect.

This research published in the journal Communication Physics can provide new insights into phenomena such as relaxation of materials due to sudden temperature changes technically called out-of-equilibrium phenomena and also can lead to diverse applications, such as giving a new perspective to thermal control in next generation electronic or defining better cooling strategies.

Aristotle, in the Meteorological, wrote, "the fact that water has previously been warmed contributes to its freezing quickly".

The phenomenon forgotten over time was rediscovered in the last century by Erasto Mpemba after whom it is now named. Since then, there has been considerable interest in understanding it and identifying whether the effect is specific only to phase transitions in water. Even though it is recently shown that the effect appears during phase transitions in several other systems, the understanding remains largely elusive. Furthermore, quite interestingly, the case of water has recently become controversial, even at the experimental level. Due to the demanding nature of water simulations, there exists no computational study to resolve the debate.



Scientists have used **supercomputer simulations** to provide evidence for the **Mpemba effect**, which states that hotter water freezes faster than colder water.

Cabinet approves CoalSETU window: Auction of coal linkages for diverse industrial uses and exports, ensuring fair access and optimal resource utilisation

Posted On: 12 DEC 2025 4:18PM by PIB Delhi

The Union Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi today has approved for the Policy for Auction of Coal Linkage for Seamless, Efficient & Transparent Utilisation (CoalSETU) by creation of new window named "CoalSETU window" in the NRS Linkage Policy to utilise coal for any industrial use and export. The new policy adds to the series of coal sector reforms being undertaken by the Government.

The Policy will allow allocation of coal linkages on auction basis on long-term for any industrial use and export by adding a separate window named CoalSETU in the NRS (Non-Regulated Sector) Linkage Auction Policy of 2016 wherein any domestic buyer requiring coal can participate in the linkage auction. The coking coal shall not be offered under this window.

The existing policy for auction of coal linkages for the NRS provides for allocation of all fresh coal linkages to NRS viz. Cement, Steel (Coking), Sponge Iron, Aluminium, and Others [excluding Fertilizer (Urea)] including their Captive Power Plants (CPPs) to be auction based. As per the present policy of NRS Linkage, the sub-sectors are for specified end users only.

Looking at the current & future market dynamics and for the purpose of ease of doing business and for accelerated utilization of existing coal reserves and reduce dependence on imported coal for meeting country's energy requirement, there was a need to have a fresh look at the current arrangements of coal supplies to the NRS, and extend the linkages in NRS to coal consumers without any end use restrictions. In line with the opening of the coal sector for commercial mining, which allowed allocation of coal blocks without any end use restrictions, this policy for auction of coal linkages for NRS has been modified for allocation of coal linkages on auction basis on long-term for any industrial use and export by adding another window/sub-sector. Traders shall not be allowed to participate in the proposed window.

The present auction of coal linkages for the specified end-user sub-sectors in NRS (Non-Regulated Sector) shall continue. The specified end-user (s), can also participate in this window.

The coal linkage obtained under this window shall be for own consumption, export of coal, or any other purpose (including coal washing) except resale in the country. Coal linkage holders will be eligible to export coal upto 50% of their coal linkage quantity. The coal linkage holders may flexibly utilize the coal obtained under this window as per their requirement amongst its Group companies. Considering the demand for washed coal, which would increase in future, the coal linkages to the Washery operators will result in increased availability of washed coal in the country and consequently reduce imports. Further, the washed coal will also find takers outside the country and therefore, the washed coal may also be used for the purpose of export.



Coal production reached a record 1,047.523 MT in 2024-25, with 33 new mines allocated in 2025. Policy reforms, including CoalSETU and revised SHAKTI, aim to enhance accessibility. The Ministry plans to increase coal self-reliance, expecting demand to hit 1.5 billion tonnes by 2030.

India and Germany sign a Joint Declaration of Intent (JDI) on Telecommunications Cooperation

JDI signed as one of the key outcomes of the engagements between the Prime Minister of India and the Federal Chancellor of Germany

Declaration builds upon the strong momentum in India-Germany relations and sustained high-level engagements

Pact paves way for collaboration in emerging Digital Technologies

India-Germany Agreement to drive Innovation in Telecom and ICTs

JDI provides for joint efforts in areas such as policy and regulatory frameworks, manufacturing, and facilitation of ease of doing business in the telecommunications and ICT sectors

Both Sides to work together closely in international fora to promote common understanding



India and Germany signed a Joint Declaration of Intent on telecom cooperation during Chancellor Friedrich Merz's visit. The agreement focuses on enhancing collaboration in policy, manufacturing, and digital technologies, aiming to improve the telecommunications and ICT business environment and strengthen bilateral relations in international forums.

Wings India 2026 to Showcase India's Aviation Ascent as the World's Fastest-Growing Civil Aviation Market

Asia's Largest Civil Aviation Event to Showcase the rise of Indian Aviation and the Future of Global Flight

Posted On: 25 JAN 2026 2:42PM by PIB Delhi

India's civil aviation sector, among the fastest-growing in the world, is set to take centre stage at **Wings India 2026**, Asia's largest civil aviation event, scheduled from **28-31 January 2026** at Begumpet Airport, Hyderabad.

The mega four-day event will be formally launched by the **Hon'ble Minister of Civil Aviation, Shri Rammohan Naidu Kinjarapu**, in the presence of senior dignitaries from India and abroad. The launch will mark the beginning of a landmark global aviation gathering that will showcase India's transformation into a major aviation hub for connectivity, manufacturing, services, innovation and sustainability.

Anchored around the theme **"Indian Aviation: Paving the Future – From Design to Deployment, Manufacturing to Maintenance, Inclusivity to Innovation and Safety to Sustainability"**, Wings India 2026 will highlight how India's aviation ecosystem has evolved into a powerful engine of economic growth, regional development and global integration.

India's Aviation Growth Story Takes Global Spotlight

Over the last decade, India's civil aviation sector has witnessed unprecedented expansion:

Passenger traffic has surged multi-fold, placing India among the world's top aviation markets.

Hundreds of new aircraft have been inducted by Indian carriers, with record-breaking aircraft orders positioning India as one of the largest future aircraft markets globally.

Airport infrastructure has expanded rapidly, with new greenfield airports, modernised terminals and enhanced regional connectivity under flagship initiatives such as UDAN.

India is emerging as a strong hub for aircraft maintenance, repair and overhaul (MRO), pilot training, aerospace manufacturing, cargo logistics, and advanced air mobility.



"Wings India 2026", Asia's biggest civil aviation event, will be held in Hyderabad from January 28-31, 2026. Theme: "Indian Aviation: Paving the Future – From Design to Deployment, Manufacturing to Maintenance, Inclusivity to Innovation and Safety to Sustainability".

INS SAGARDHWANI FLAGS OFF FOR SAGAR MAITRI V

Posted On: 18 JAN 2026 1:40PM by PIB Delhi

INS Sagardhwani, India's oceanographic research vessel under the Naval Physical and Oceanographic Laboratory (NPOL) of DRDO, was flagged off for the fifth edition of the *Sagar Maitri* (SM-5) initiative from Southern Naval Command, Kochi on 17 Jan 2026.

The vessel was flagged off by Shri Radha Mohan Singh, Honourable Member of Parliament and Chairperson, Parliamentary Standing Committee on Defence, in the presence of honourable Members of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Defence, Dr Samir V Kamat, Secretary, Department of Defence R&D and Chairman DRDO; RAdm Upal Kundu, Chief of Staff, Southern Naval Command; Dr R. V. Hara Prasad, Director General (Naval Systems & Materials); and Dr Devvuri Sethagiri, Director, NPOL, along with senior officials from the Indian Navy and DRDO.

Sagar Maitri is a flagship collaborative initiative of the Indian Navy and DRDO, aligned with the Government of India's vision of 'Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions (MAHASAGAR)'. The initiative aims to promote closer cooperation in socio-economic aspects and greater scientific interaction, especially in ocean research, among Indian Ocean Rim (IOR) countries.

Naval Physical and Oceanographic Laboratory (NPOL), Kochi has been conducting oceanographic missions under the *Sagar Maitri* programme with the objective of strengthening scientific cooperation and capacity building among IOR nations. Under the aegis of this programme, DRDO initiated a scientific component titled '*MAITRI* (Marine & Allied Interdisciplinary Training and Research Initiative)' to establish long-term collaboration with IOR countries in the field of ocean research and development.

Under the *Sagar Maitri* programme, INS Sagardhwani will retrace the historic routes of INS Kistna, which participated in the International Indian Ocean Expedition during 1962-65. The initiative seeks to build sustained scientific collaboration with eight IOR countries, namely Oman, Maldives, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Malaysia, Singapore, Indonesia, and Myanmar. The ongoing mission marks the initiation of collaborative oceanographic studies with Maldives, enabling joint research and professional exchange among scientists of IOR nations.

Sagar Maitri represents the centrepiece of DRDO's efforts towards achieving relevant Underwater Domain Awareness (UDA) for the Indian Navy. During these missions, oceanographic and acoustic data of importance are collected along designated observational tracks by DRDO research vessel INS Sagardhwani, aligned with planned scientific objectives relevant to UDA.

INS Sagardhwani is a specialised marine acoustic research vessel designed by NPOL and built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE). Commissioned in Jul 1994, the ship has served as a key platform for ocean observations and marine research for over three decades, contributing significantly to India's maritime scientific capabilities.



INS Sagardhwani, a DRDO research vessel, was launched for the **Sagar Maitri V** mission to enhance oceanographic collaboration with eight Indian Ocean Rim nations. Builds on the legacy of **INS Kistna** to improve scientific connections and underwater awareness. Built by **GRSE**, the vessel has been active in marine research since 1994.

Lucknow Leads as UP's First Zero Fresh Waste Dump City

Lucknow achieved 100% scientific processing of municipal solid waste under the Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban

Newly commissioned Shivari Solid Waste Management Plant has a processing capacity of 700 metric tonnes per day

Lucknow's door-to-door waste collection efficiency has improved to 96.53%, and source segregation levels are above 70%

Posted On: 21 JAN 2026 2:00PM by PIB Delhi



Lucknow is Uttar Pradesh's **first zero fresh waste dump city**, achieving **100% scientific waste processing under the Swachh Bharat Mission**. The **Shivari plant processes 700 metric tonnes daily**, with a door-to-door collection efficiency of **96.53%** and over **70% source segregation**.

President of India inaugurates Granth Kutir at Rashtrapati Bhavan

Granth Kutir is a collection of about 2,300 books in 11 Classical Languages of India

wealth of knowledge accumulated in classical languages inspires us to learn from our rich past and build a bright future: President Droupadi Murmu

Posted On: 23 JAN 2026 7:11PM by PIB Delhi

The President of India, Smt Droupadi Murmu, inaugurated Granth Kutir at Rashtrapati Bhavan today (January 23, 2026). Granth Kutir has a rich collection of manuscripts and books in 11 classical languages of India which are Tamil, Sanskrit, Kannada, Telugu, Malayalam, Odia, Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali.



President Droupadi Murmu inaugurated **Granth Kutir at Rashtrapati Bhavan**, housing around **2,300 books in India's 11 classical languages**, including Sanskrit, Tamil, and Odia. The collection aims to preserve and promote classical literary heritage and inspire learning from the past.

LONG RANGE TRAINING DEPLOYMENT OF INDIAN NAVY'S FIRST TRAINING SQUADRON (1TS) TO SOUTH EAST ASIA

प्रतिष्ठित तिथि: 07 JAN 2026 4:39PM by PIB Delhi

The ships of the First Training Squadron (1TS) of the Indian Navy — **INS Tir, Shardul, Sujata and ICGS Sarathi** — will be proceeding on a Long Range Training Deployment (LRTD) to South East Asia as part of a training curriculum of the 110th Integrated Officers' Training Course (IOTC).

As part of the deployment, the squadron is scheduled to undertake port calls at **Singapore, Indonesia and Thailand**. The deployment is aimed at providing comprehensive operational and cross-cultural exposure to officer trainees, while reinforcing India's sustained maritime engagement with South East Asian nations in consonance with India's Act East Policy and vision for a free, open and inclusive Indian Ocean Region.

During these port visits, a wide range of professional interactions, training engagements and cooperative activities are planned with the host navies and maritime agencies. These include structured training exchanges, cross-deck visits, interactions with various subject matter experts and Joint Maritime Partnership exercises.

These engagements are designed to further enhance interoperability, mutual trust and understanding, while promoting the exchange of best practices at sea.

The 110th Integrated Officers' Training Course includes **six international officer trainees**, reflecting Indian Navy's continued commitment to capacity building and professional training of personnel from friendly foreign Nations.

In addition, personnel from the Indian Army and the Indian Air Force are also embarked for the deployment, further strengthening jointness and cohesiveness between the services.

The Long Range Training Deployment underscores the Indian Navy's emphasis on training excellence whilst contributing to maritime diplomacy, goodwill and cooperative approach to regional maritime security.



Indian Navy's First Training Squadron Deployment to South East Asia

- Indian Navy Squadron: **First Training Squadron (1TS)**
- Ships deployed: **INS Tir, Shardul, Sujata, ICGS Sarathi.**

ving

INS SUDARSHINI TO EMBARK ON TRANSOCEANIC SAIL EXPEDITION - LOKAYAN 26

10-month expedition covering 18 ports across 13 countries

Voyage to include participation in Escalade à Sète (France) and SAIL 250 (USA)

प्रतिष्ठित तिथि: 19 JAN 2026 6:28PM by PIB Delhi

The Indian Navy's Sail Training Ship INS Sudarshini will embark on the flagship voyage of Lokayan 26, a 10-month transoceanic expedition, on 20 Jan 2026. Reflecting India's rich maritime heritage and the vision of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam across the oceans, the ship will sail over 22,000 nautical miles, visiting 18 foreign ports across 13 countries.

A key highlight of the deployment will be INS Sudarshini's participation in prestigious international tall-ship events – Escalade à Sète, in France, and SAIL 250, in New York, USA. In both these events, INS Sudarshini will be representing India's proud seafaring legacy and maritime traditions.

During the course of the voyage, over 200 Indian Navy and Indian Coast Guard trainees will undergo intensive sail training, gaining invaluable experience in long-range ocean navigation and traditional seamanship at sea. The deployment will expose the trainees to nuances of life onboard a tall ship and provide opportunities for interaction with trainees of other Navies, fostering professional exchange and building enduring bonds of friendship.

INS Sudarshini will also participate in training interactions and maritime partnership engagements with the Navies of visiting countries, strengthening maritime cooperation and advancing the vision of MAHASAGAR. The voyage stands as a powerful symbol of cultural diplomacy, reaffirming the Indian Navy's commitment to Building Bridges of cooperation and mutual trust across nations.

INS Sudarshini, the second sail training ship of the Indian Navy, has covered over 1,40,000 nautical miles to date. Through Lokayan 26, she continues to serve as a beacon of India's maritime strength, professionalism, and goodwill on the global stage.



INS Sudarshini is on a 10-month voyage, **Lokayan 26**, covering 22,000 nautical miles and visiting 18 ports in 13 countries. The expedition includes tall-ship events in France and the USA, providing sail training for over 200 naval and coast guard trainees while strengthening maritime partnerships under India's global cooperation vision.

INS Sudarshini



- Second sail training ship after INS Tarangini
- Sailed >1,40,000 nautical miles to date
- Symbol of maritime diplomacy & naval professionalism



SPORTS



Sonam Yeshey of Bhutan etched his name into the history books by becoming the first bowler ever to take **eight wickets** in a men's T20 International.



Deepthi Sharma has become the **highest wicket-taker** in Women's T20 International cricket. She claimed her **152nd T20I wicket**, overtaking Australia's Megan Schutt, who previously held the record with 151 wickets.



The Indian women's hockey team won the silver medal at the 2025 Women's Asia Cup in China, finishing runners-up after a narrow loss to the hosts. India topped the group stage and reached the final with consistent performances.



The **Vidarbha** cricket team defeated Saurashtra by 38 runs to win the **Vijay Hazare Trophy** for the first time. Vidarbha has previously won the Ranji Trophy, but this is their **first** Vijay Hazare Trophy win.



The BCCI signed a **₹270 crore** sponsorship deal with Google's AI platform Gemini for a **three-year period** covering multiple IPL seasons. IPL 2026 will be the first season to be held under the new Gemini-BCCI partnership.



The International Cricket Council (ICC) has officially confirmed that **Scotland** will replace Bangladesh in the upcoming **ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026**, co-hosted by India and Sri Lanka.

→ Italy



ECONOMICS



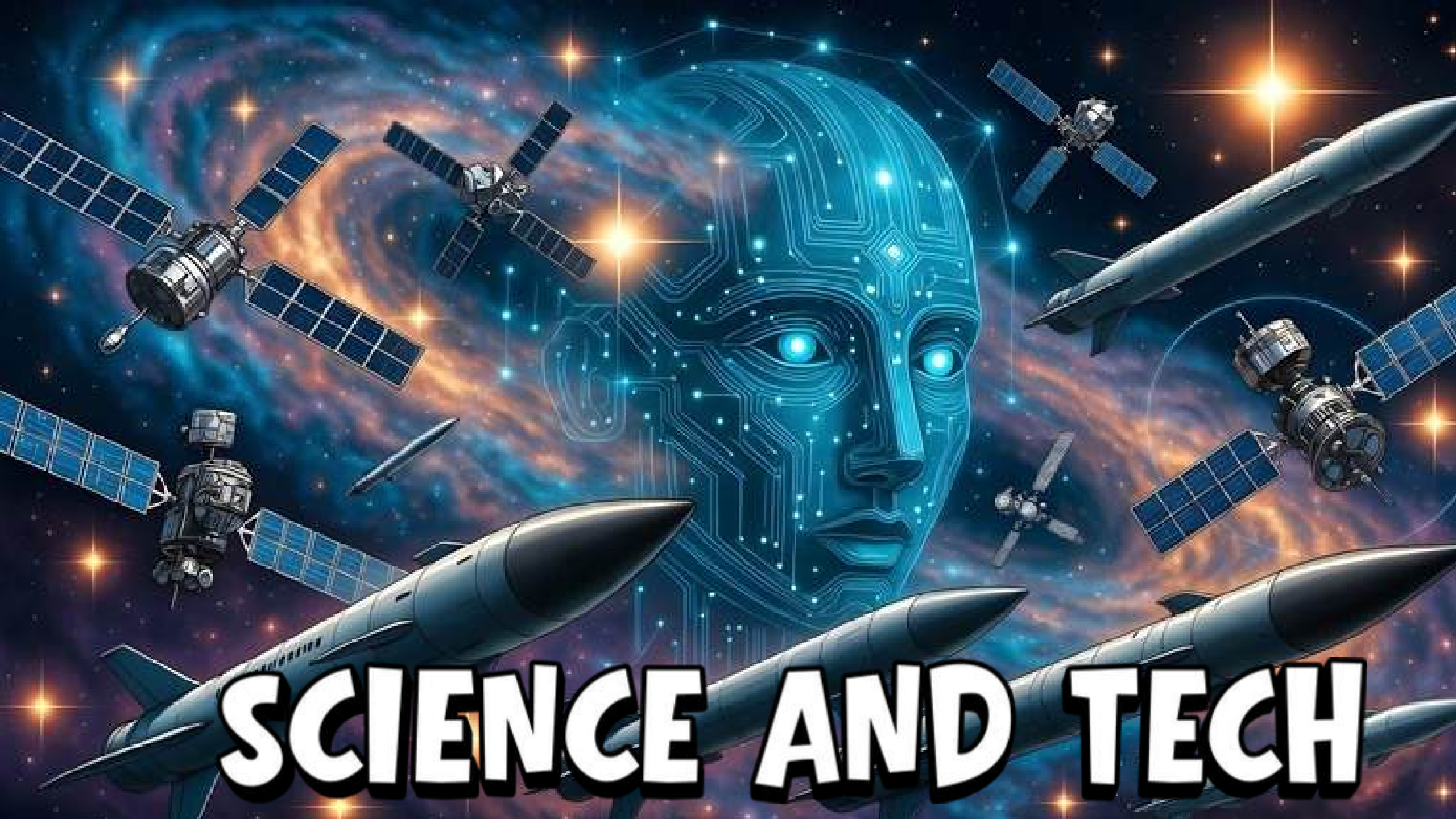
The Delhi Government and the Reserve Bank of India have signed a Memorandum of Understanding, bringing Delhi under the RBI's banking, cash management, and debt management framework for the first time. The RBI will serve as the banker, debt manager, and financial agent for the Government of Delhi.

ORANGE ECONOMY

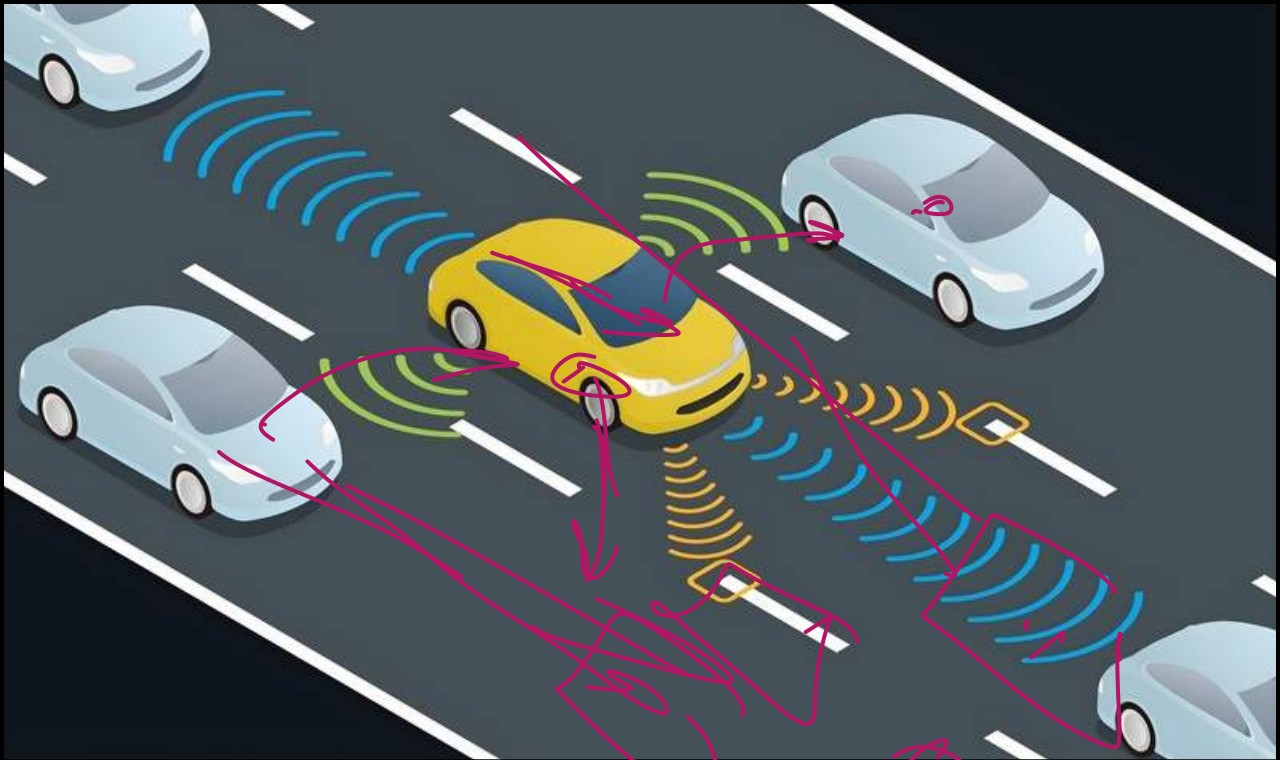
A CREATIVE LEAP TOWARD INCLUSIVE GROWTH



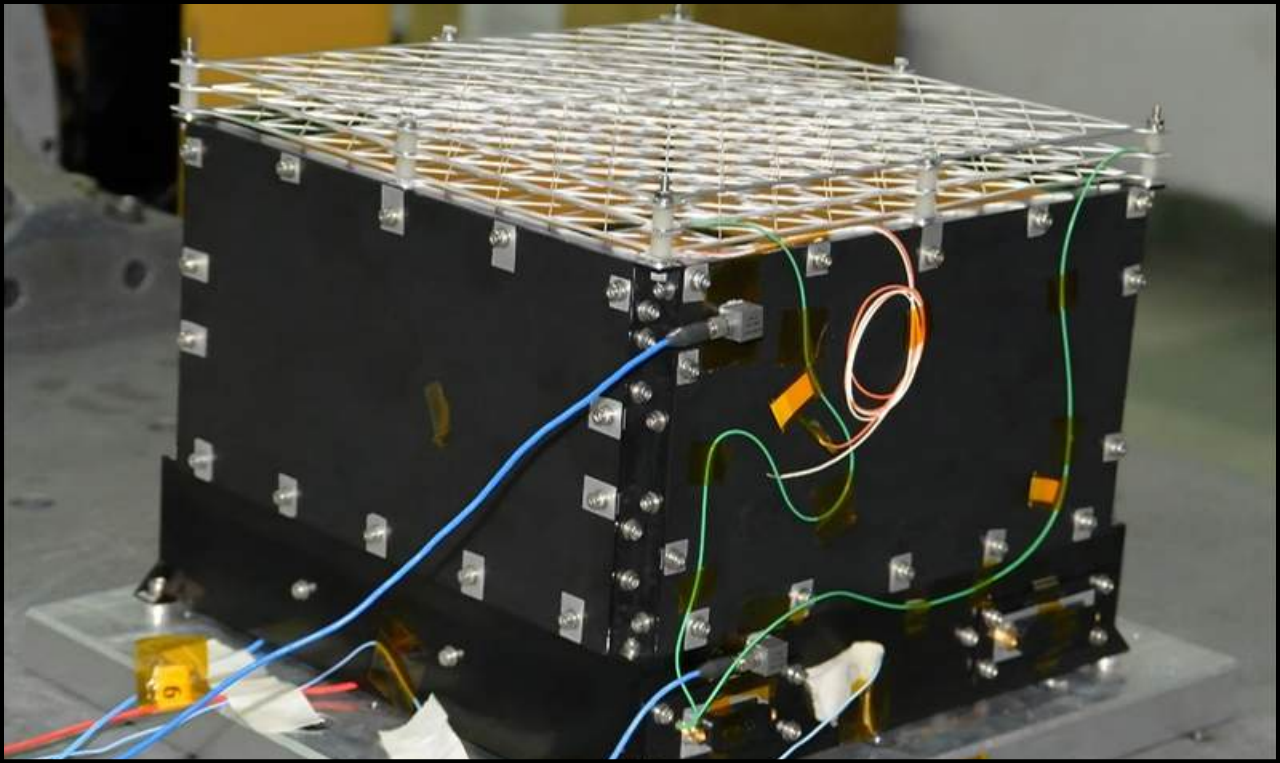
The **Orange economy** includes industries that use **creativity, knowledge, and intellectual property (IP)** to create value, such as film, music, art, design, OTT platforms, architecture, and publishing.



SCIENCE AND TECH



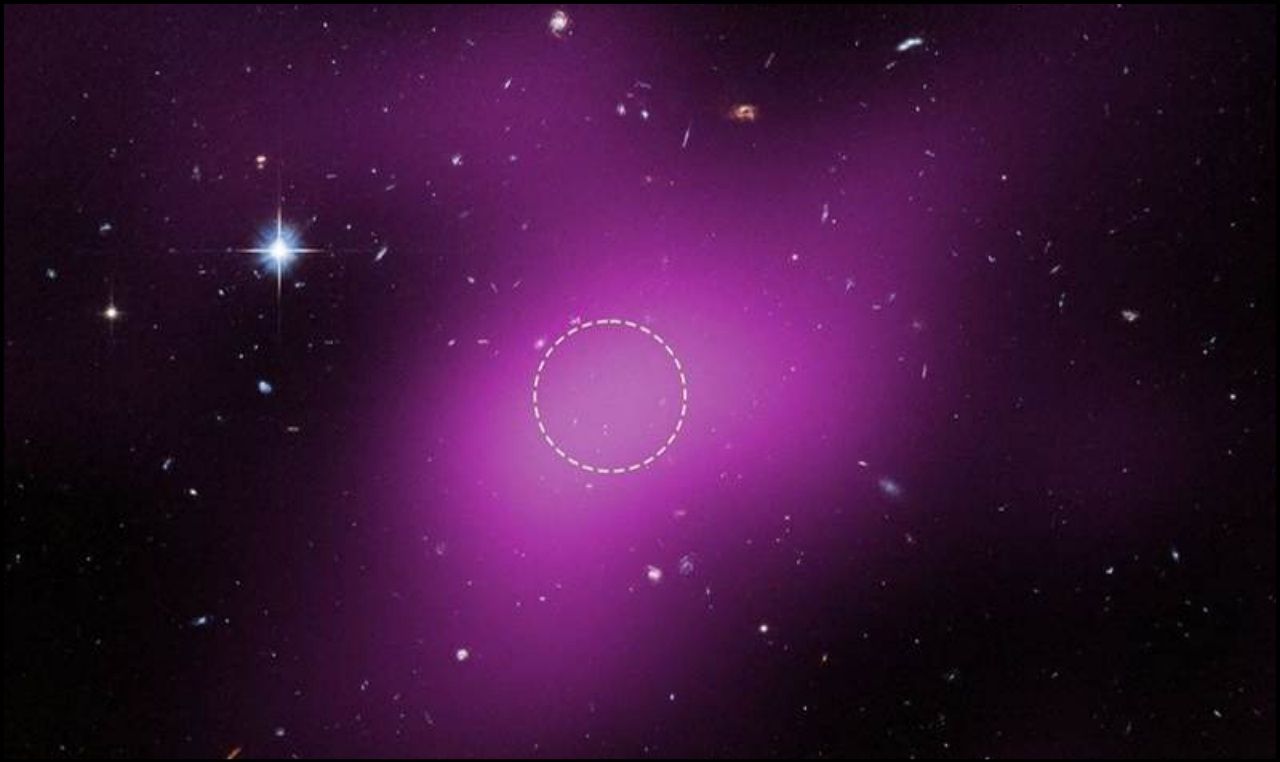
India plans to roll out **Vehicle-to-Vehicle (V2V)** communication technology nationwide by **end-2026**. The system enables direct vehicle-to-vehicle communication without mobile or internet networks. It aims to improve road safety and reduce traffic accidents.



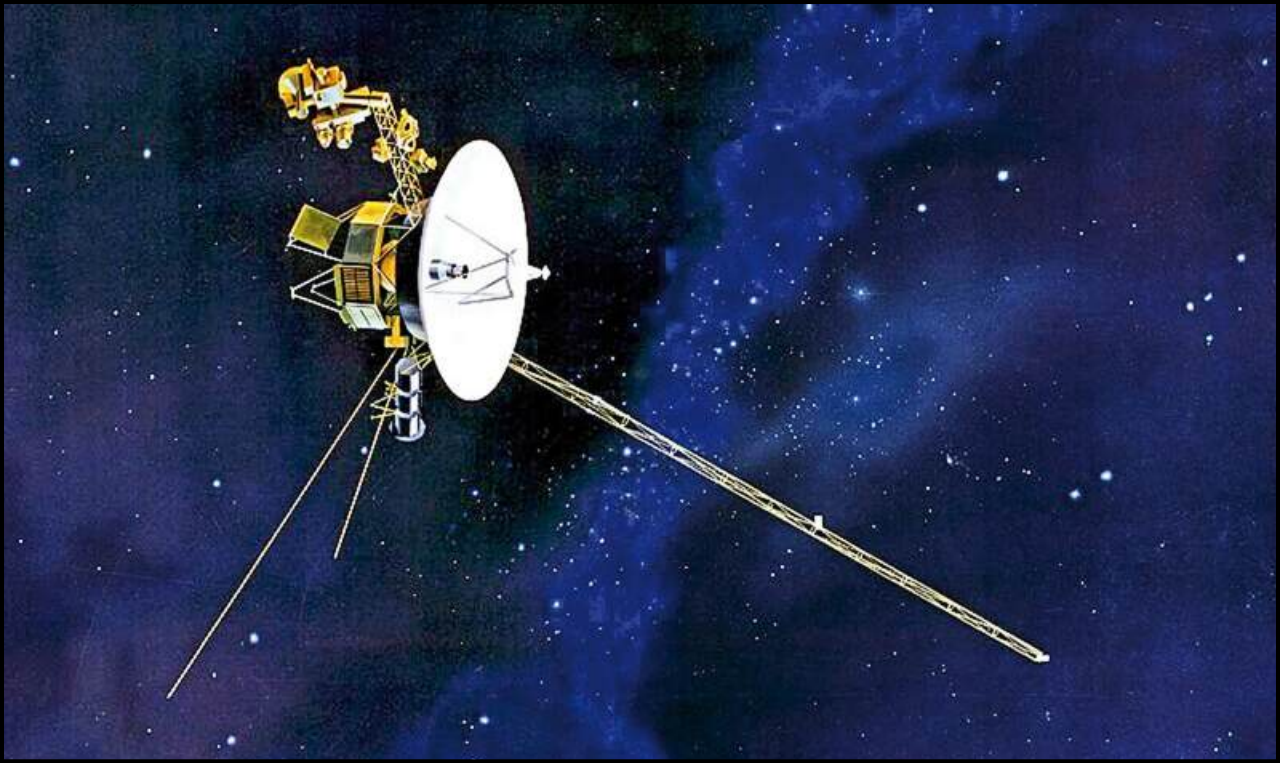
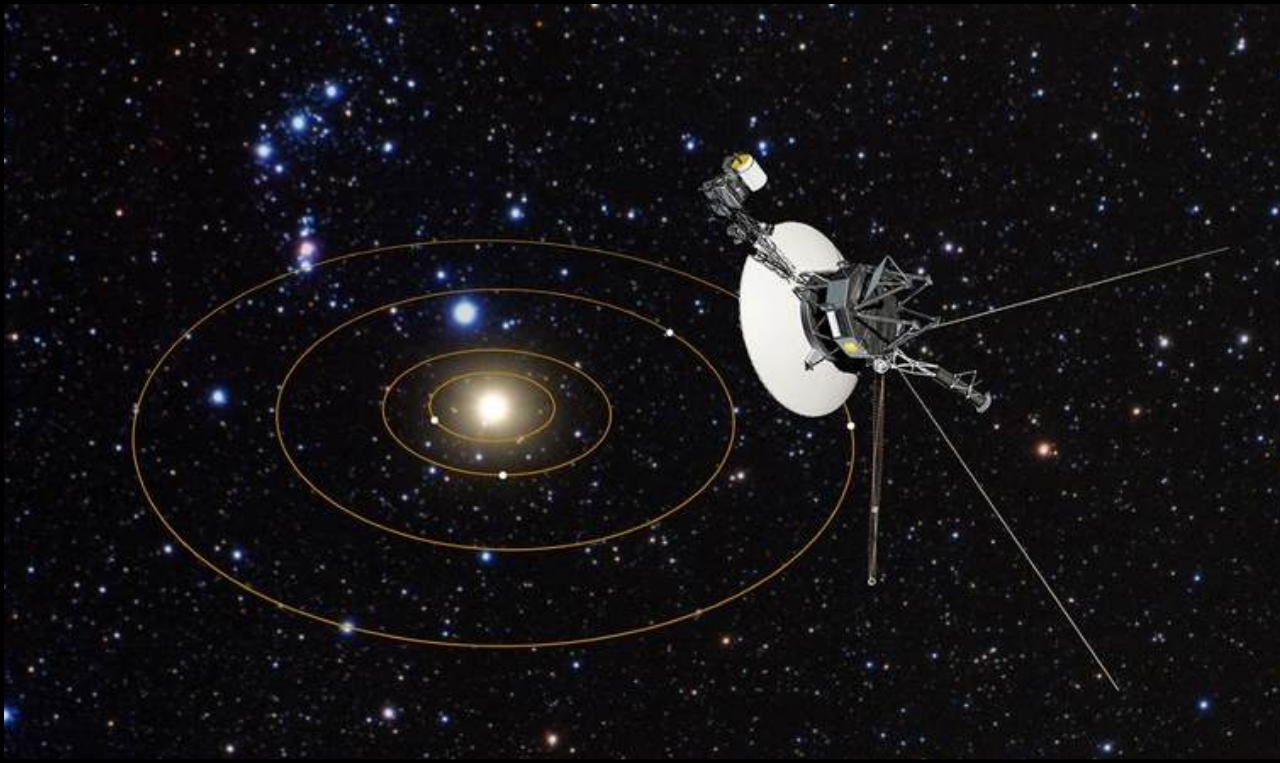
ISRO's Dust Experiment (DEX) found that one interplanetary dust particle enters Earth's atmosphere every 1,000 seconds. DEX is ISRO's first experiment to measure small atmospheric dust particles around Earth.



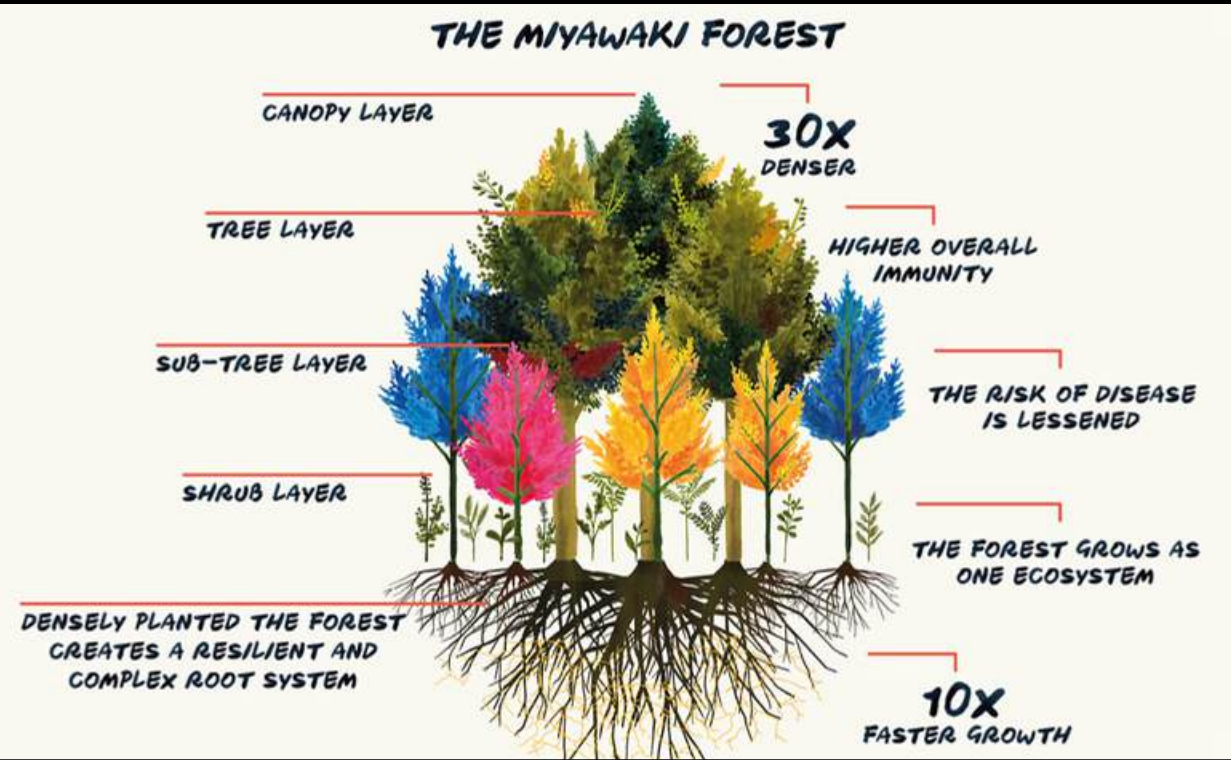
IIT Madras launched **"Param Shakti"**, an indigenously developed supercomputing system with a peak performance of 3.1 petaflops. The system was built in collaboration with **C-DAC** and is based on the RUDRA server series



NASA's Hubble Space Telescope has identified a mysterious cloud named **"Cloud 9."** It is a remnant of early galaxy formation containing dark matter and **neutral hydrogen only**, with no stars, earning it the tag of a "ghostly galaxy."

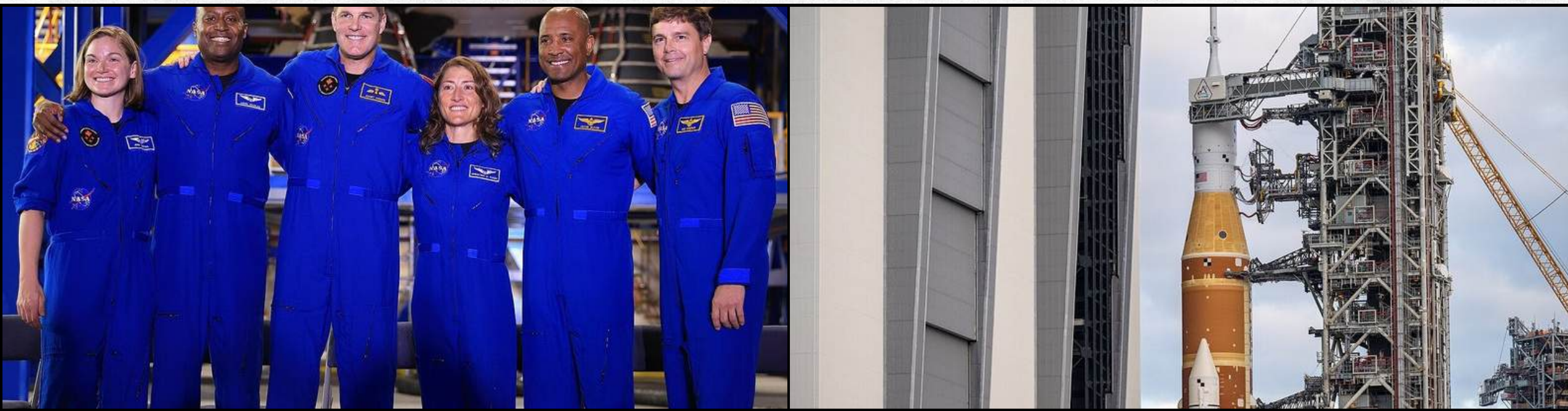


Voyager 1, launched by **NASA in 1977**, is exploring interstellar space and remains the **most distant human-made object**. It is expected to become the first spacecraft to reach one light-day distance from Earth, the distance light travels in 24 hours.

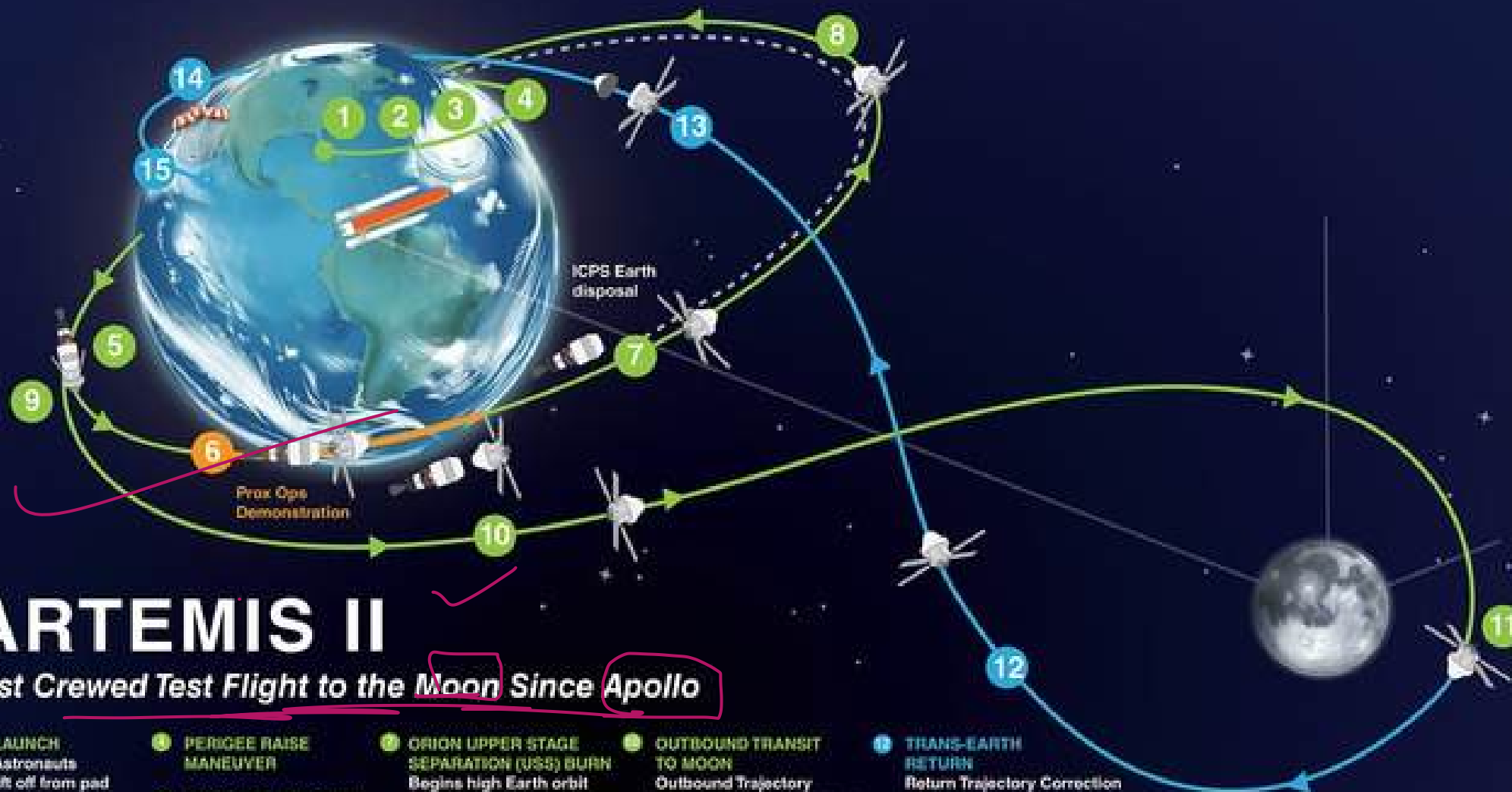


The **Miyawaki method** is gaining popularity in Indian cities for urban greening and climate resilience as green cover declines. Created by Japanese botanist **Akira Miyawaki**, this technique involves dense planting of native species, enabling forests to grow up to 10 times faster while promoting biodiversity and ecological stability.

ARTEMIS II MISSION



Artemis II is NASA's upcoming crewed lunar flyby mission, marking the first human journey around the Moon in over 50 years. It is part of the Artemis program aimed at returning humans to the Moon and preparing for future Mars missions.



ARTEMIS II

First Crewed Test Flight to the Moon Since Apollo

- 1 LAUNCH
Astronauts lift off from pad 39B at Kennedy Space Center.
- 2 JETTISON SOLID ROCKET BOOSTERS, FAIRINGS, AND LAUNCH ABORT SYSTEM
- 3 CORE STAGE MAIN ENGINE CUT OFF
With separation.
- 4 PERIGEE RAISE MANEUVER
- 5 APOGEE RAISE BURN
Begin 23.5 hour checkout of spacecraft.
- 6 ORION SEPARATION FROM INTERIM CRYOGENIC PROPULSION STAGE (ICPS) FOLLOWED BY PROX OPS DEMO
Plus manual handling qualities assessment for up to 2 hours.
- 7 ORION UPPER STAGE SEPARATION (USS) BURN
Begins high Earth orbit checkout, life support, exercise, and habitation equipment evaluations.
- 8 PERIGEE RAISE BURN
- 9 TRANS-LUNAR INJECTION (TLI) BY ORION'S MAIN ENGINE
Lunar free return trajectory initiated with European service module.
- 10 OUTBOUND TRANSIT TO MOON
Outbound Trajectory Correction (OTC) burns as necessary for Lunar free return trajectory; travel time approximately 4 days.
- 11 LUNAR FLYBY
6,479 miles / 10,427 km (mean) lunar farside altitude.
- 12 TRANS-EARTH RETURN
Return Trajectory Correction (RTC) burns as necessary to aim for Earth's atmosphere; travel time approximately 4 days.
- 13 CREW MODULE SEPARATION FROM SERVICE MODULE
- 14 ENTRY INTERFACE (EI)
Enter Earth's atmosphere.
- 15 SPLASHDOWN
Ship recovers astronauts and capsule.

PROXIMITY OPERATIONS DEMONSTRATION SEQUENCE	
1	9
2	10
3	11
4	12
5	13
6	14
7	15
8	16
9	17

Mission at a glance:

- Type: Crewed lunar flyby (not landing)
 - Crew: 4 astronauts – NASA + Canadian Space Agency
 - Duration: ~10 days
 - Launch site: Kennedy Space Center, Florida, USA
- Crew members: Reid Wiseman, Victor Glover, Christina Koch & Jeremy Hansen (Canada)
- Launch windows:
- Primary: Feb. 6–11, 2026
 - Secondary: March & April 2026 (if needed)



APPOINTMENTS



Rabindra Kumar Agarwal has been appointed as **Chairman & Managing Director, Food Corporation of India** in the rank and pay of Additional Secretary to the Government of India.

Food Corporation of India

- o Founded: 1965
- o Headquarters: New Delhi



Lieutenant General Harpal Singh has been appointed as the **29th Director General of the Border Roads Organisation (BRO)**, replacing Lieutenant General Raghu Srinivasan and taking charge from January 1, 2026.

Border Roads Organisation (BRO)

- Established - 7 May 1960
- Headquarters - New Delhi
- Parent organisation - Ministry of Defence



A.K. Balasubrahmanian was appointed
Chairman of the Atomic Energy
Regulatory Board in January 2026.

Atomic Energy Regulatory Board (AERB)
Founded : 15 November 1983, Mumbai
Headquarters : Mumbai ✱
Chairman : Dinesh Kumar Shukla





AWARDS

83rd Golden Globe Awards 2026



CBS PRESENTS
**GOLDEN
GLOBES**

HOSTED BY
NIKKI GLASER

LIVE JANUARY 11, 2026

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The 83rd Golden Globe Awards in 2026 took place at the Beverly Hilton, California, where Leonardo DiCaprio's film ***One Battle After Another*** won five awards. Nikki Glaser hosted the ceremony for the second year in a row.

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Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla received the **Ashok Chakra**, India's highest peacetime gallantry award, for exceptional courage and leadership. He is the first Indian to visit the International Space Station

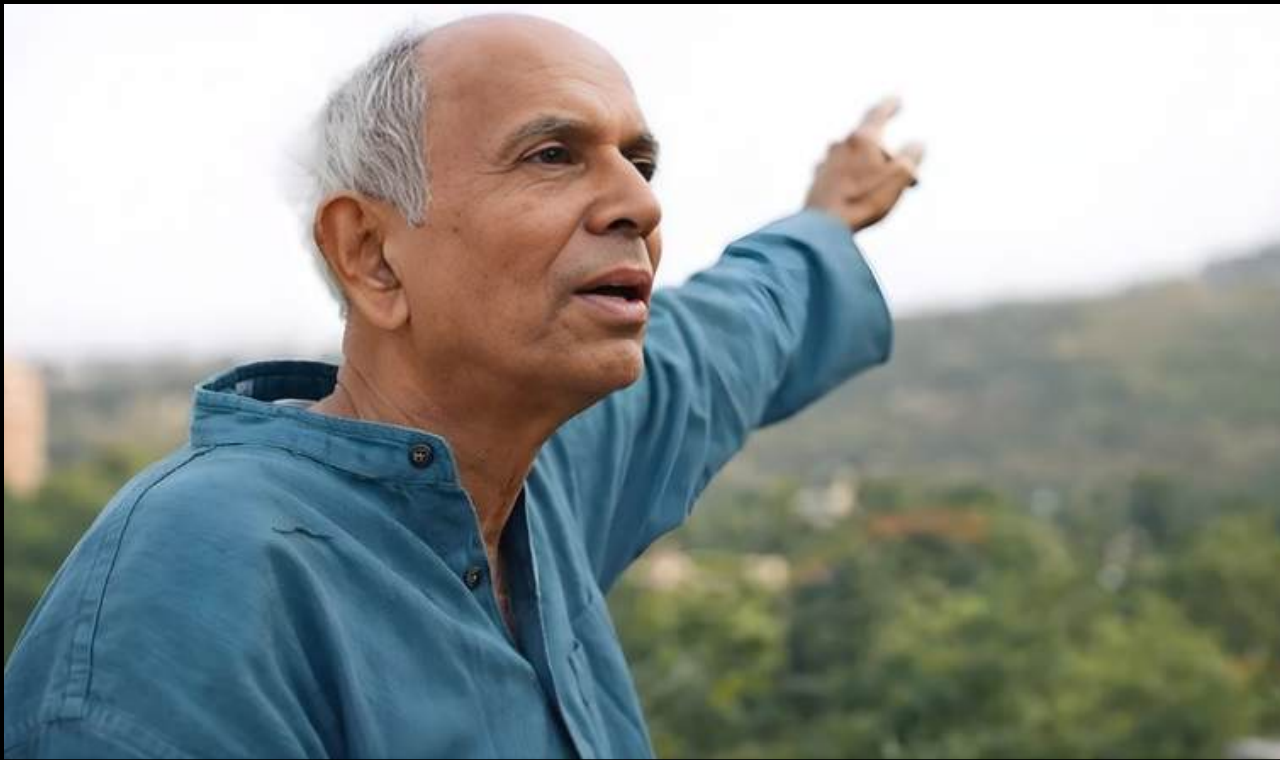




MISCELLANEOUS

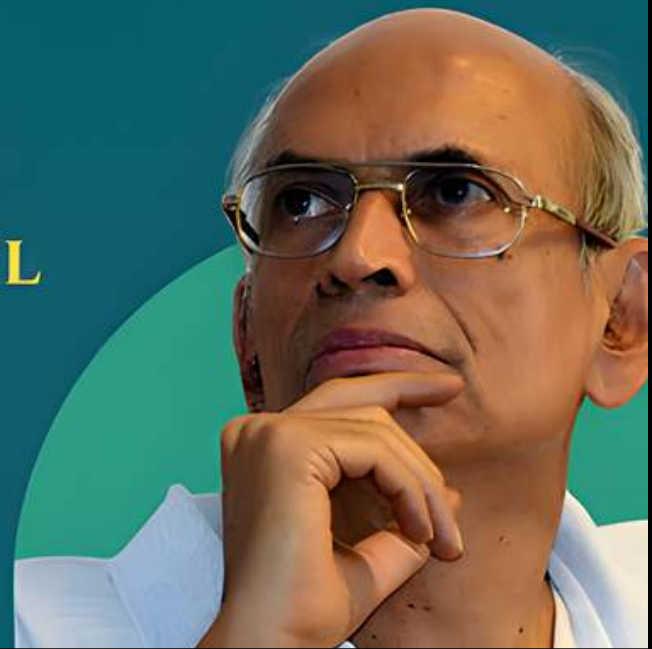
Archaeologists in Pakistan have discovered 2,000-year-old Kushan Empire coins and lapis lazuli fragments at Bhir Mound near Taxila in Rawalpindi. The coins belong to the era of King Vasudeva, one of the last great Kushan rulers.





Remembering
MADHAV GADGIL

24 MAY 1942- 7 JAN 2026



Madhav Gadgil, a prominent **Indian ecologist**, died on January 7, 2026, in Pune after a brief illness. He led the **Western Ghats panel**, which created a significant report for conservation efforts in this vital biodiversity hotspot.



The **United Nations** designated 2026 as the **'International Year for Rangelands and Pastoralists'** to highlight the importance of these often-overlooked ecosystems.



INTERNATIONAL YEAR OF
**RANGELANDS AND
PASTORALISTS**
2026

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